

CHAO-TANG LIN

2018-2026 Selected Projects

M.S.AAD, Columbia GSAPP
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EDUCATION

Columbia University, Graduate School of Architecture, Planning and Preservation (GSAPP) 05/2025–05/2026
Master of Science degree in Advanced Architectural Design
New York, US

Tunghai University (THU) 09/2014–06/2019
Bachelor of Architecture
Taichung, Taiwan

EXPERIENCE

KRIS YAO | ARTECH (2025 AIA International Firm Award) 06/2020–01/2024
Architectural Designer
Taipei, Taiwan

- **Facade Design & Technical Documentation:** Developed exterior envelope designs from SD through CD for large-scale projects, including a ~**930,000 sq ft** hospital and a ~**490,000 sq ft** headquarters. Coordinated with structural and curtain wall consultants on material studies to optimize performance, successfully meeting **Gold-level Green Building** and **Intelligent Building** standards.
- **Regulatory Review & Urban Renewal:** Formulated revised designs and compliance measures for Urban Renewal and Cultural Heritage reviews. Produced in-depth reports and historical sightline simulations, successfully achieving a **20% additional floor area incentive** and introducing **15% more pedestrian space**.
- **Construction Administration (CA):** Supported the CA phase by executing shop drawing reviews and conducting on-site mockup inspections, ensuring design fidelity and structural feasibility.
- **Physical Modeling & Visualization:** Fabricated physical models and produced visual materials to effectively communicate complex design concepts, spatial relationships, and site integrations to internal teams and external agencies.

Chien Architects & Associates 07/2018–08/2018
Architectural Intern
Taipei, Taiwan

- Contributed to interior material specifications for public administrative areas, fabricating physical mockups.

FieldEvo Design Studio + LinBoYang Architects 07/2016–08/2016
Architectural Intern
Taipei, Taiwan

- Assembled structural models for the Taichung Flora Expo Service Center, enabling architects and engineers to evaluate early design proposals presentation.

LICENSE

Architect 2025–Present
Credential ID (113)000031 | Issued by *Ministry of the Interior (Taiwan)*

HONORS & AWARDS

TACTICAL URBANISM NOW! 2025, Finalist | Issued by *Terraviva Competitions* 12/2025

Columbia GSAPP Studio Summit 06/2025
Selected as studio representatives to present the final design work at the school-wide Studio Summit.

EXHIBITION

“Below the Wugu Mountain” Video Installation, 691 Art Gallery 12/2021
Expanded thesis research through photography and interviews, spotlighting local policy, environmental, and social issues in a multimedia video piece

SKILLS

Design: Rhino, Revit, AutoCAD, SketchUp, V-ray, Enscape, Adobe Suite (Ps, Ai, Id, Pr)
Research: Microsoft Office Suite, QGIS
Fabrication: Physical Model Making, Laser Cutting, 3D Printing, Vacuum Forming
Languages: Mandarin (Native); Taiwanese Hokkien (Fluent)

REFERENCES

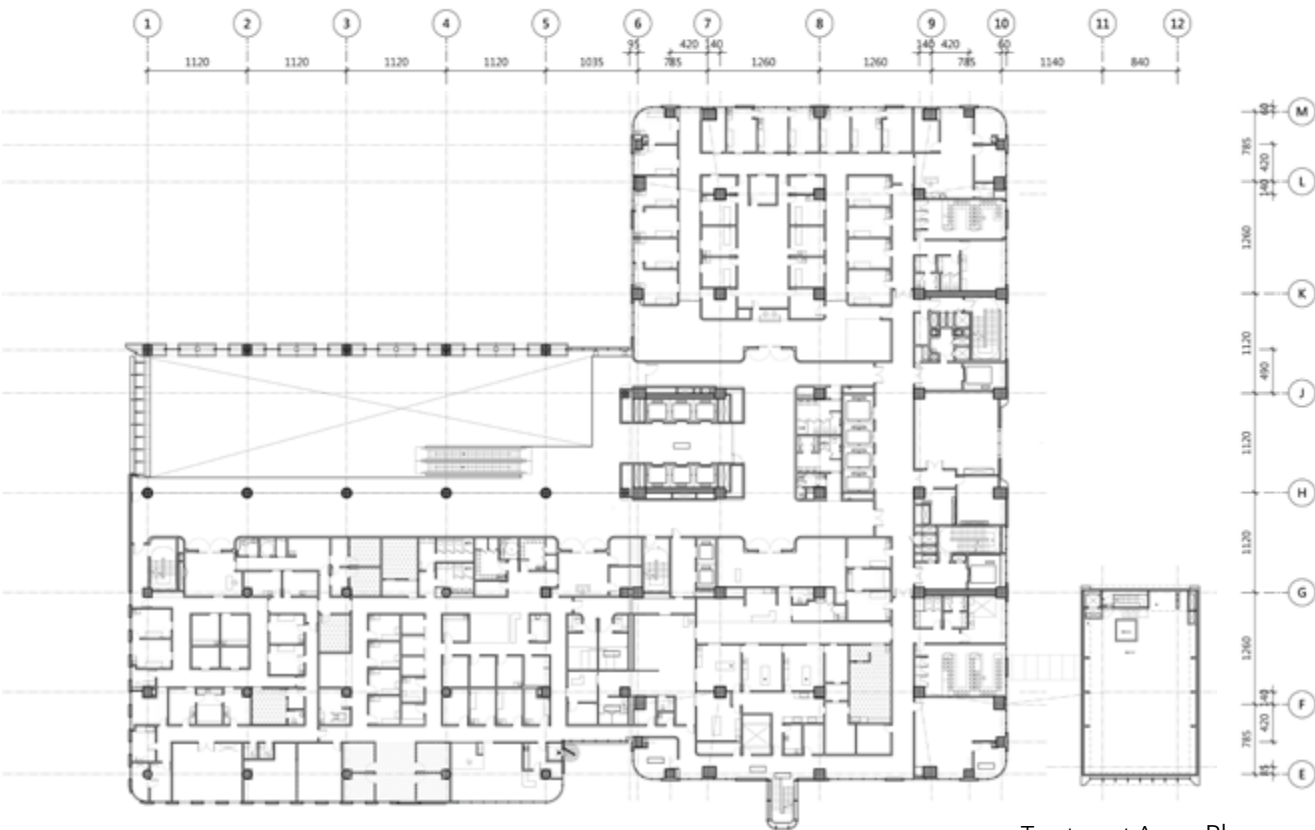
Kris Yao, Hon. FAIA | Founder, KRIS YAO | ARTECH
Email: krisyao@krisyaoartech.com

Leslie Gill, Adjunct Professor, GSAPP | Principal, Leslie Gill Architect
Email: leslie@lesliegill.com | Tel: 917-364-0072

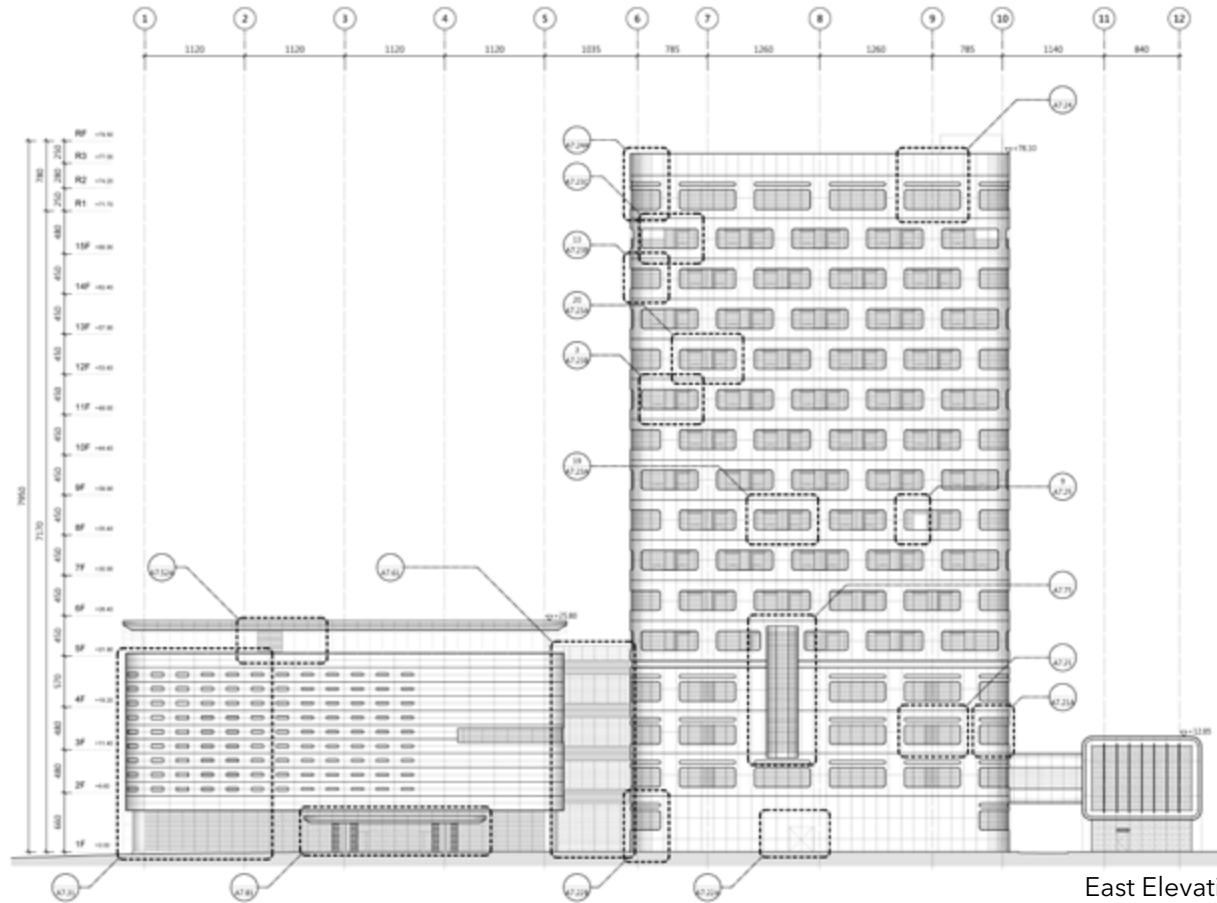
Chuming Hospital

Year: 2019-Present
Location: Hsinchu, Taiwan
Office: KRIS YAO | ARTECH
Project Director: Kris Yao (Hon. FAIA), Naiwen Cheng
Role: (DD/CD)
Facade design/Material research/model studies
Structural & curtain wall consultant coordination

A smart medical center integrating patient-focused design with sustainable systems. The facade design addresses distinct functional needs of patient rooms and treatment areas while meeting green building requirements. The shading, carefully detailed to integrate aluminum panel systems with RC structure for efficient construction and maintenance.



Treatment Areas Plan

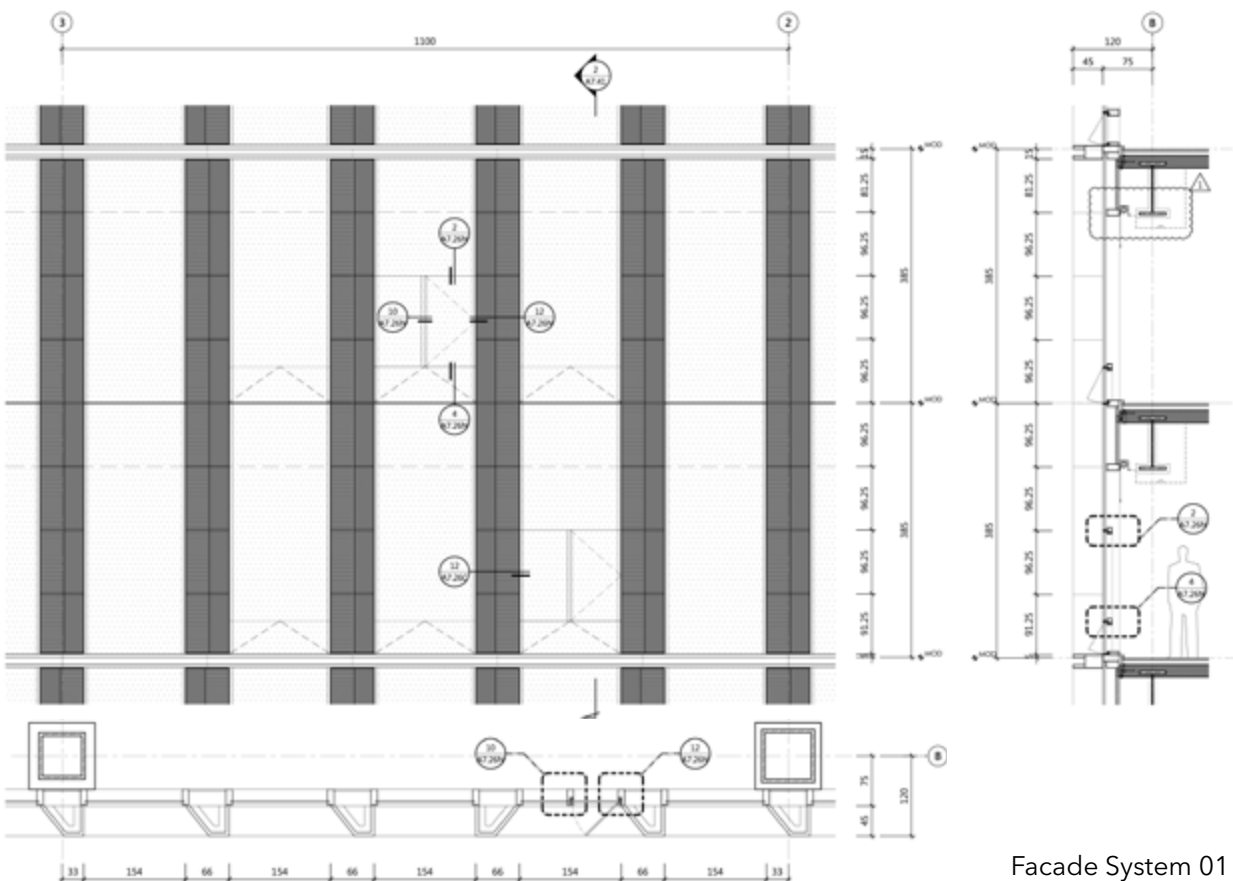
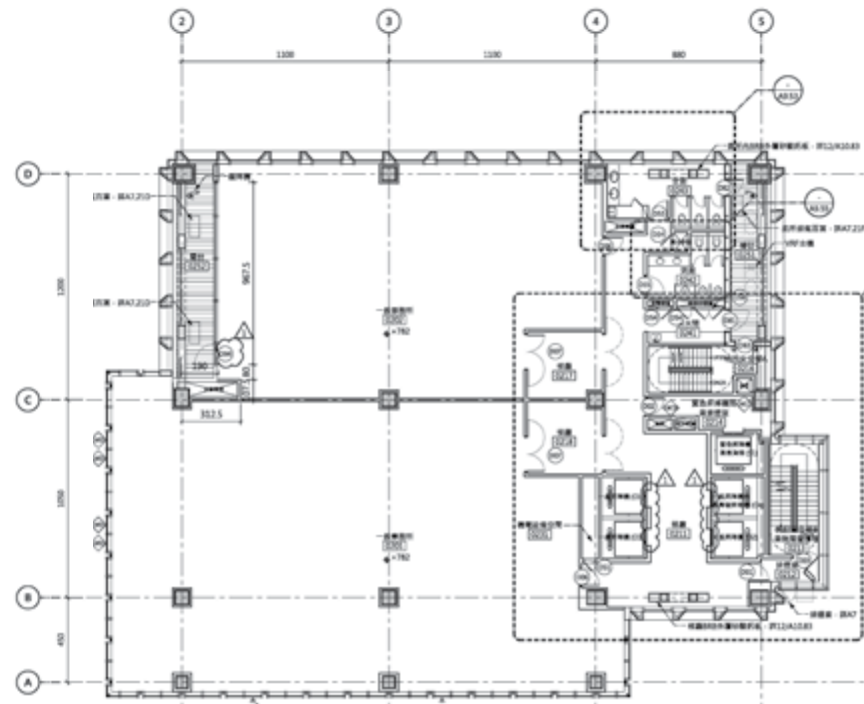


East Elevation

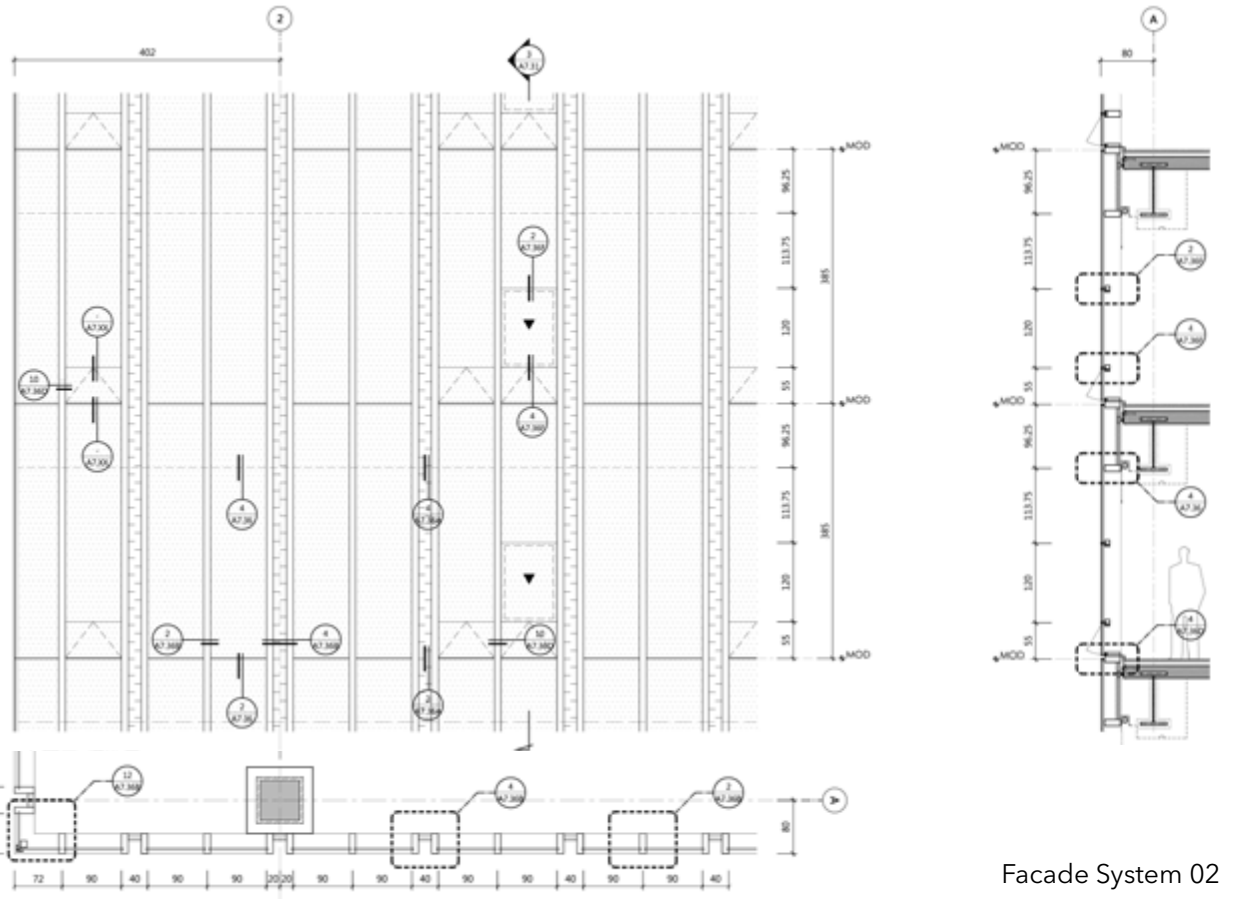
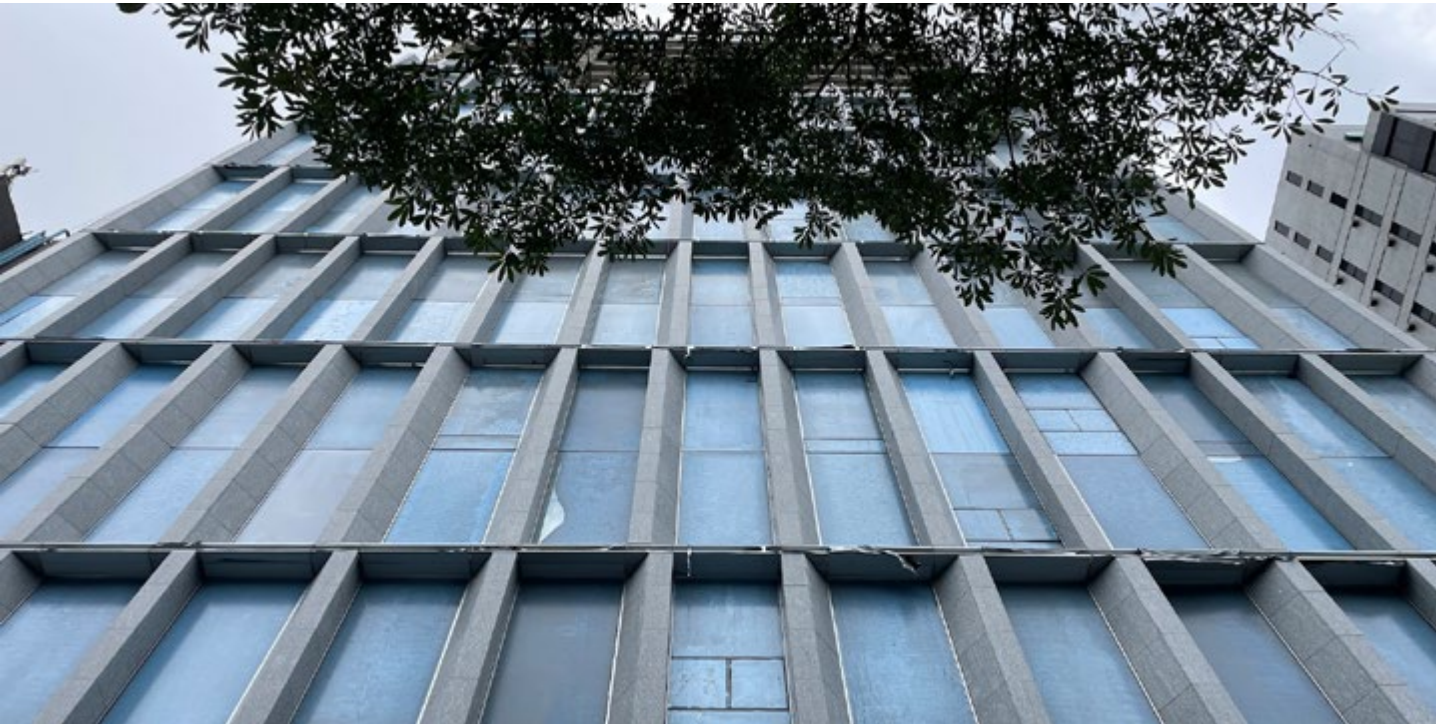
Rich Development Headquarters

Year: 2018-Present
Location: Taipei, Taiwan
Office: KRIS YAO | ARTECH
Project Director: Kris Yao (Hon. FAIA), Naiwen Cheng
Role: (DD/CD/CA)
Construction Documents & facade integration
Shop drawing reviews/ On-site mockup inspections

A commercial tower focused on refined curtain wall integration. The design development resolved complex interfaces between different facade systems through rigorous mock-up testing and collaboration with consultants, optimizing transom and mullion details, stone jointing, ceramic glass patterns, and lighting integration.



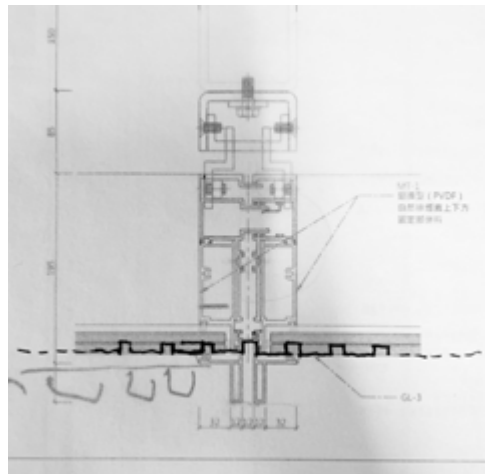
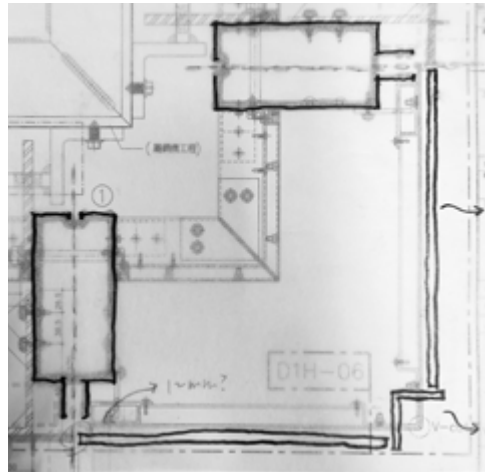
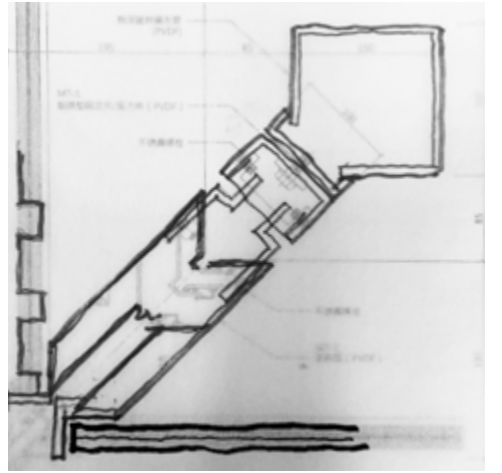
Facade System 01



Facade System 02



FS02

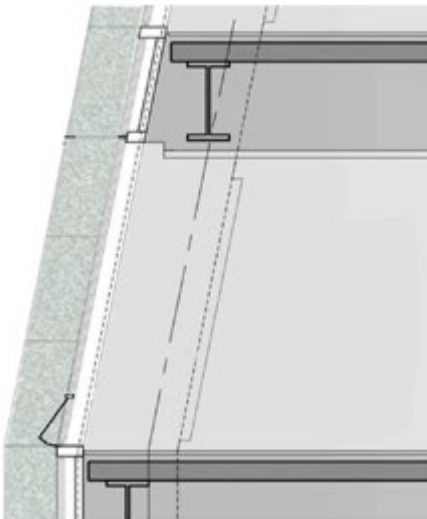
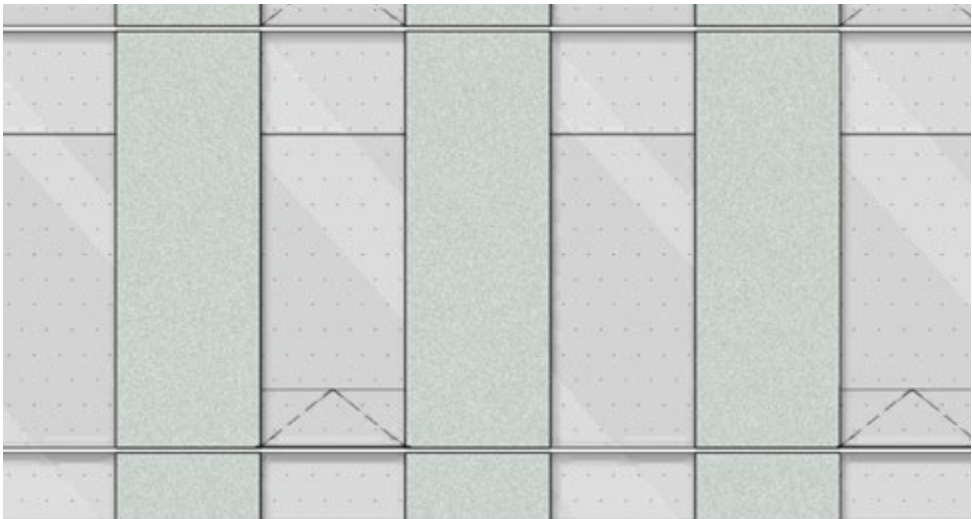
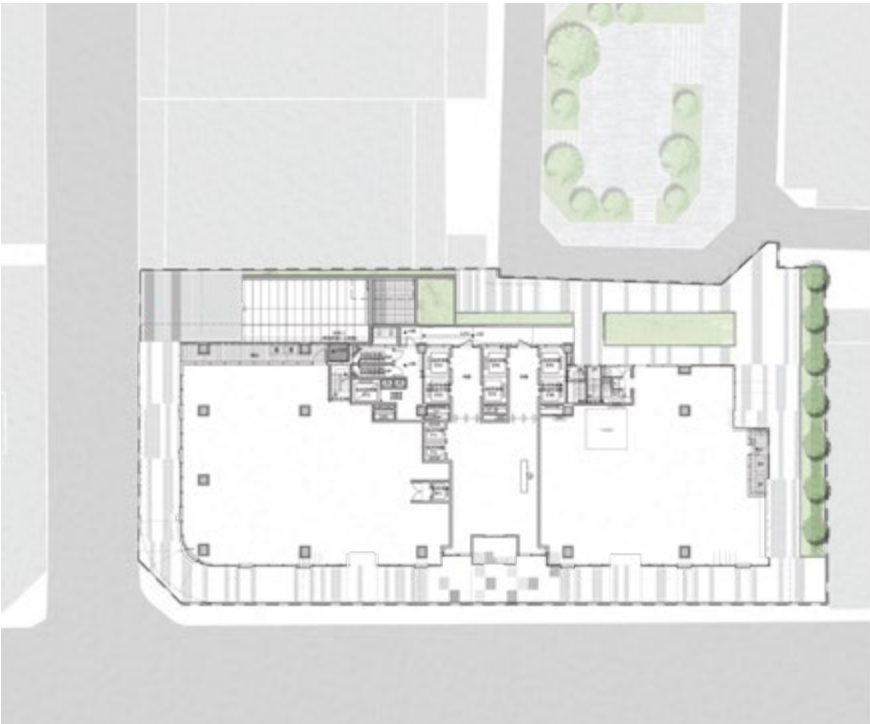
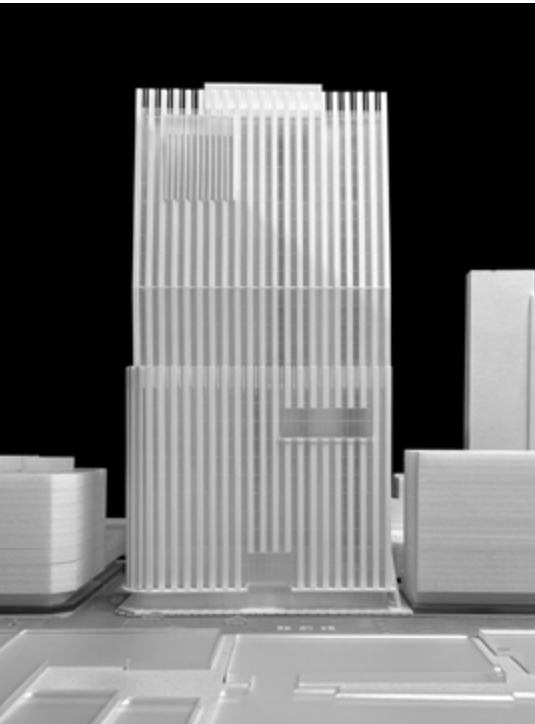
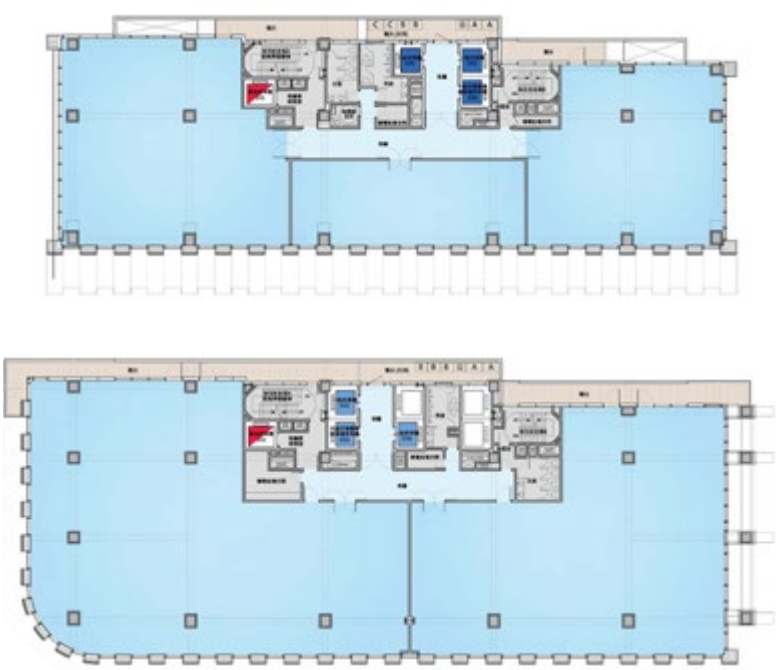


Visual mock-ups and physical material samples were used to verify the as-built appearance of curtain wall components, including mullion and transom profiles, stone panel joints, and metal panel interfaces. Coordination with the contractor focused on resolving dimensional tolerances and surface finish requirements at panel-to-panel and panel-to-frame conditions.

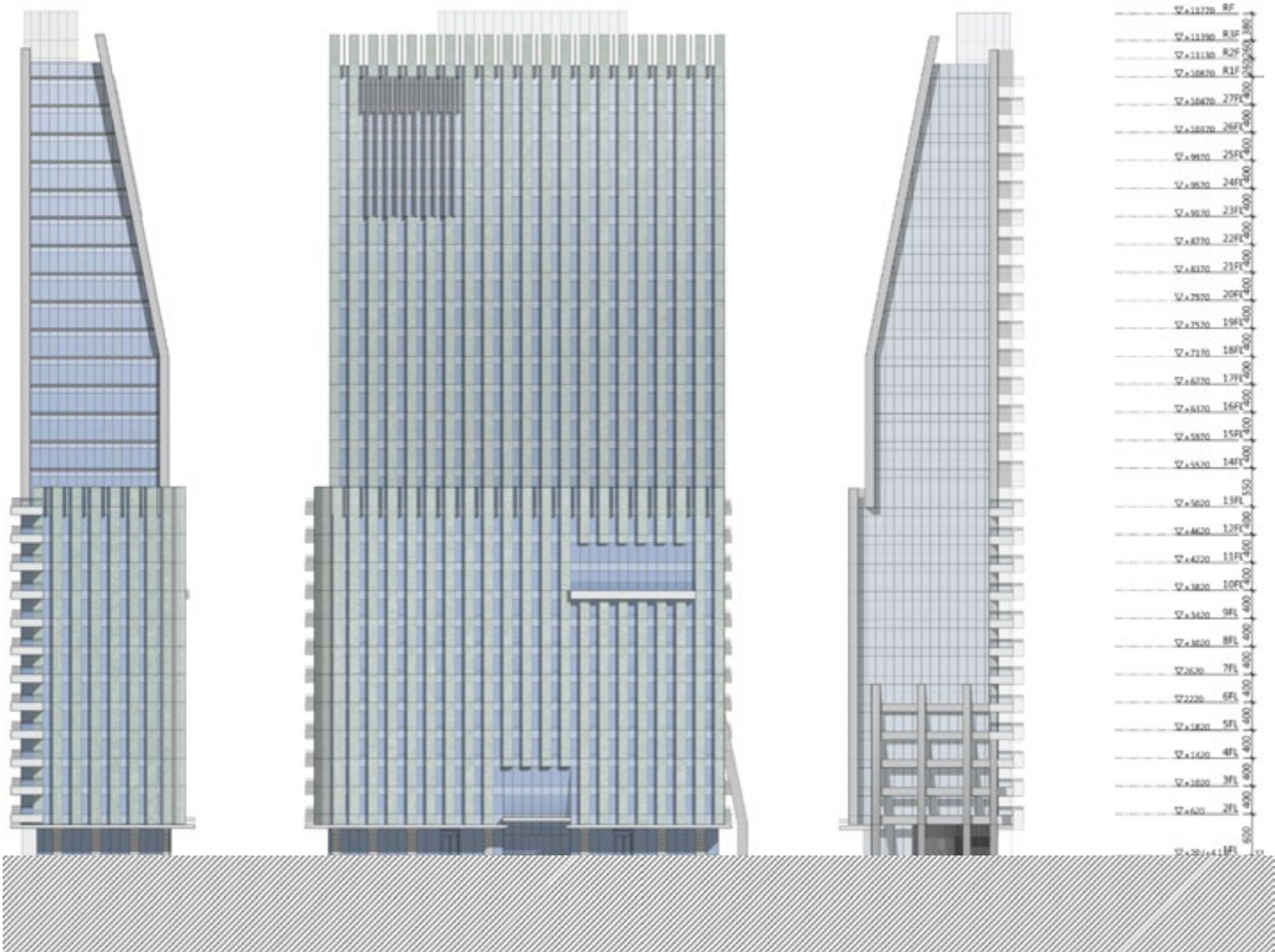
Radium Life Tech Headquarters

Year: 2020-Present
Location: Taipei, Taiwan
Office: KRIS YAO | ARTECH
Project Director: Kris Yao (Hon. FAIA), Naiwen Cheng
Role: (Competition/SD)
Urban Renewal & Heritage Protection filings
MEP & Structural consultant coordination

An urban renewal project in Taipei's historic district navigating complex regulatory requirements alongside design development. Work included facade material studies – coordinating stone panel setback requirements in response to five adjacent historic structures – as well as sightline analysis and heritage review submissions. Building massing and facade articulation were developed in close coordination with municipal review processes.



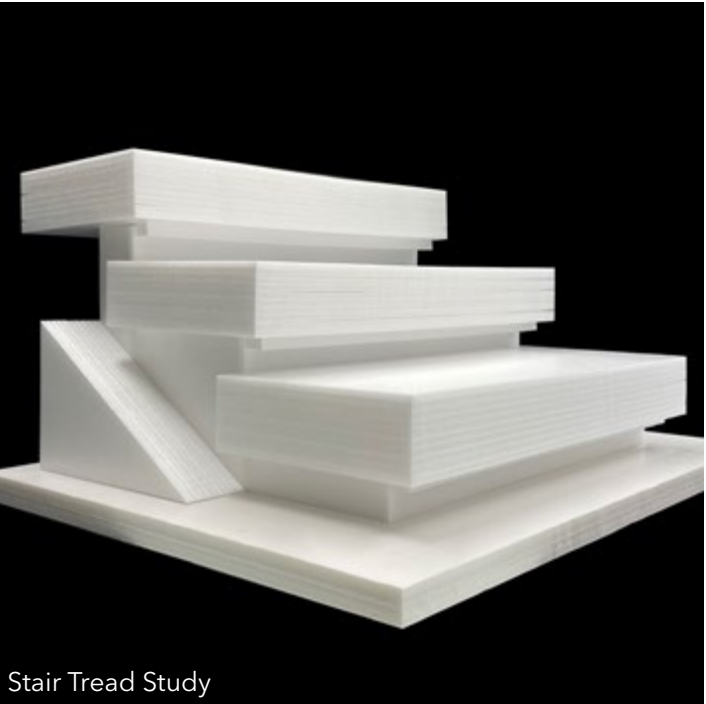
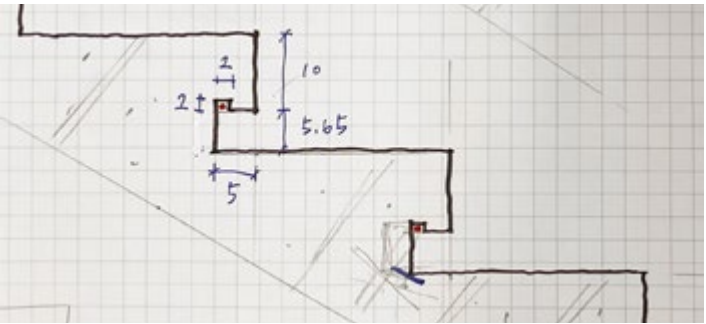
Facade System



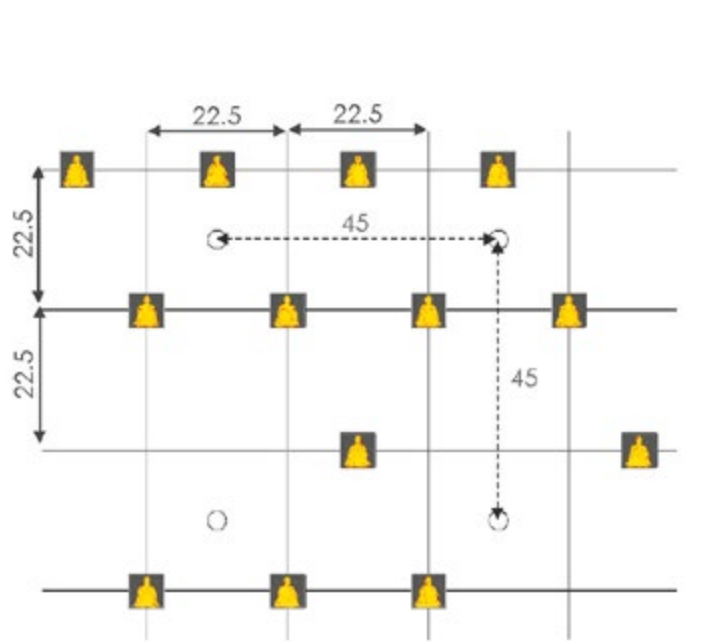
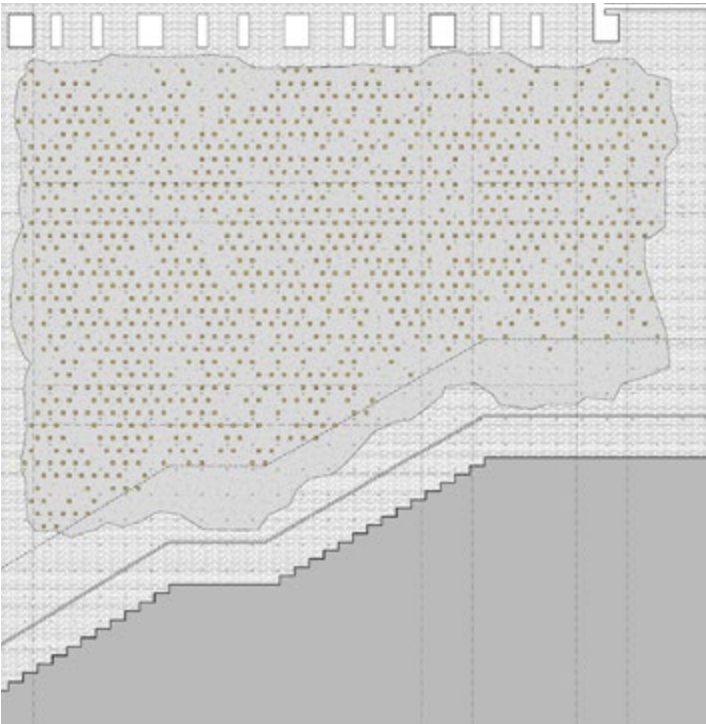
Nalandabodhi Buddhist Center

Year: 2020-2023
Location: Taipei, Taiwan
Office: KRIS YAO | ARTECH (Design Architect)
Project Director: Kris Yao (Hon. FAIA), Naiwen Cheng
Role: (CD/CA)
Precast stair & Concrete wall Shop drawing review
Construction progress tracking/Mock-up coordination

The project required detailed development of two key elements during CD phase: a precast stair system and a monumental concrete wall. Stair detailing resolved the integration of prefabricated treads with recessed lighting. The wall development addressed surface treatment methodology, formwork patterning, and the modular layout of 1,002 embedded Buddha niches – verified through on-site mock-ups with the contractor. Responsibilities also included shop drawing review and progress tracking.



Stair Tread Study



Buddha Niche Module



The Restorative Spine

A Territorial Cycle Between Manhattan and Hart Island

This project examines the narrative of death in New York City, a profound story currently suspended between two disparate and vulnerable islands: Manhattan and Hart Island. For over a century, Hart Island has served as the municipal burial site for the city's unclaimed, yet today it faces an existential threat from severe coastal erosion, rising sea levels, and a rapidly depleting burial capacity. Conversely, Manhattan has legally prohibited human burials south of 86th Street since 1850, rendering the island a sterile void disconnected from the natural cycles of life and death.

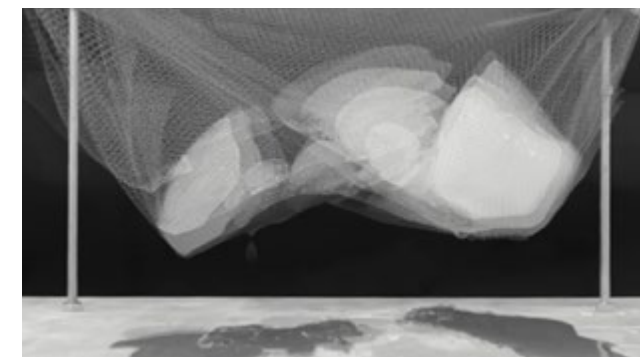
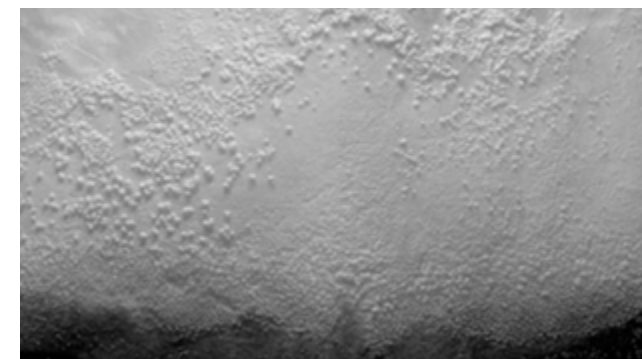
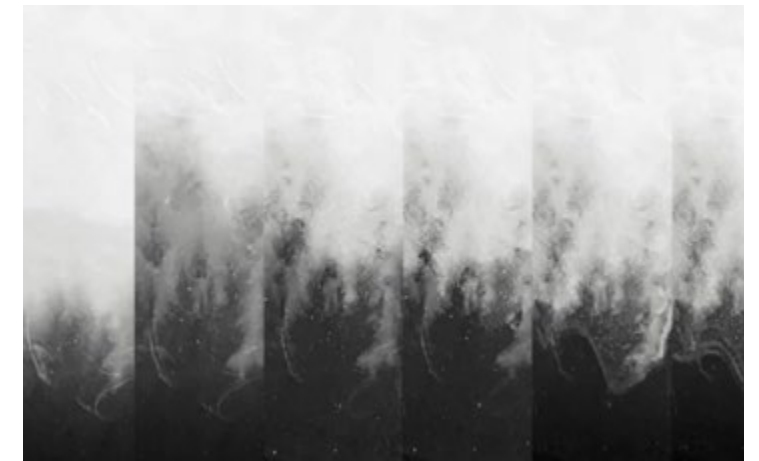
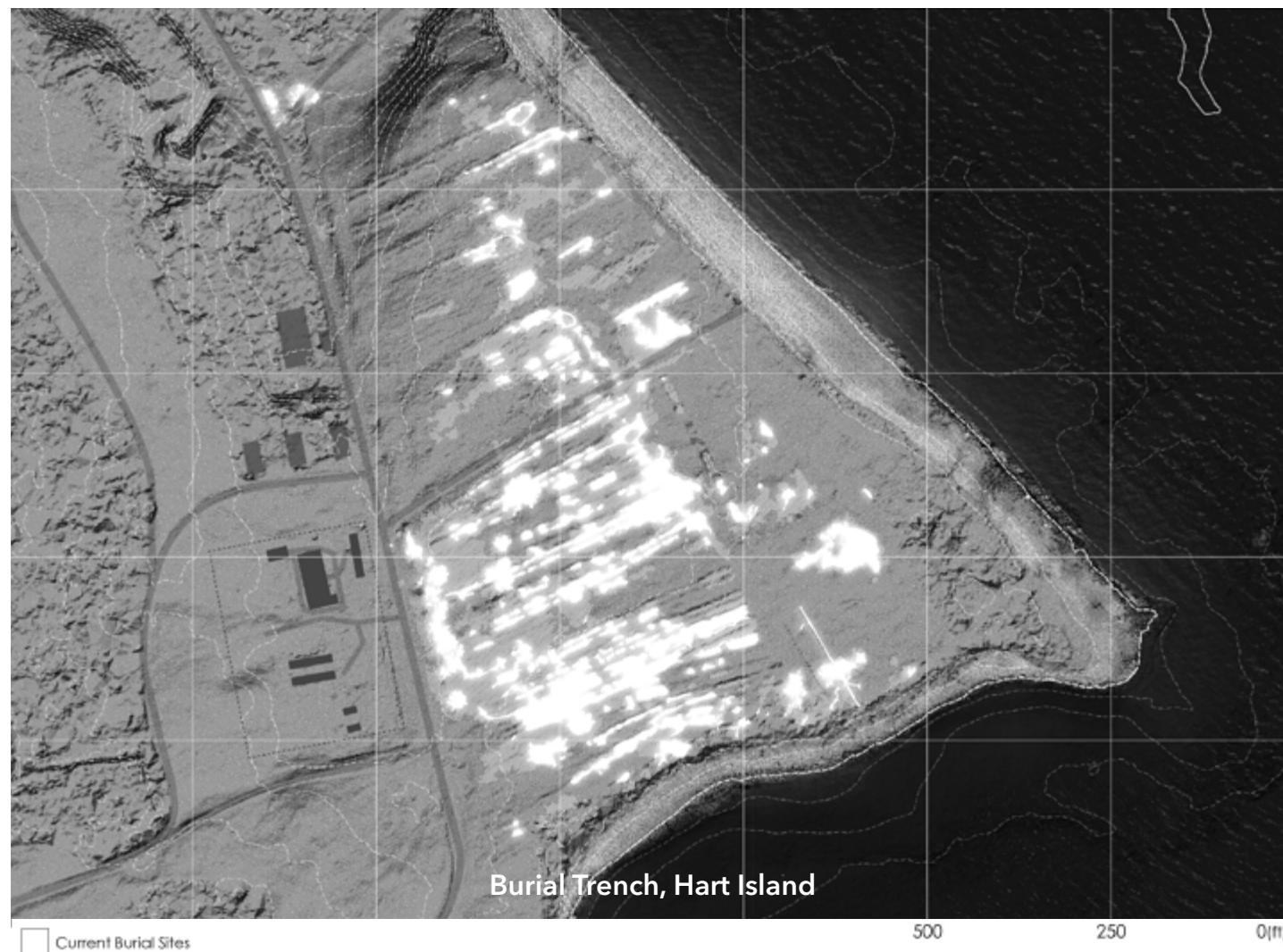
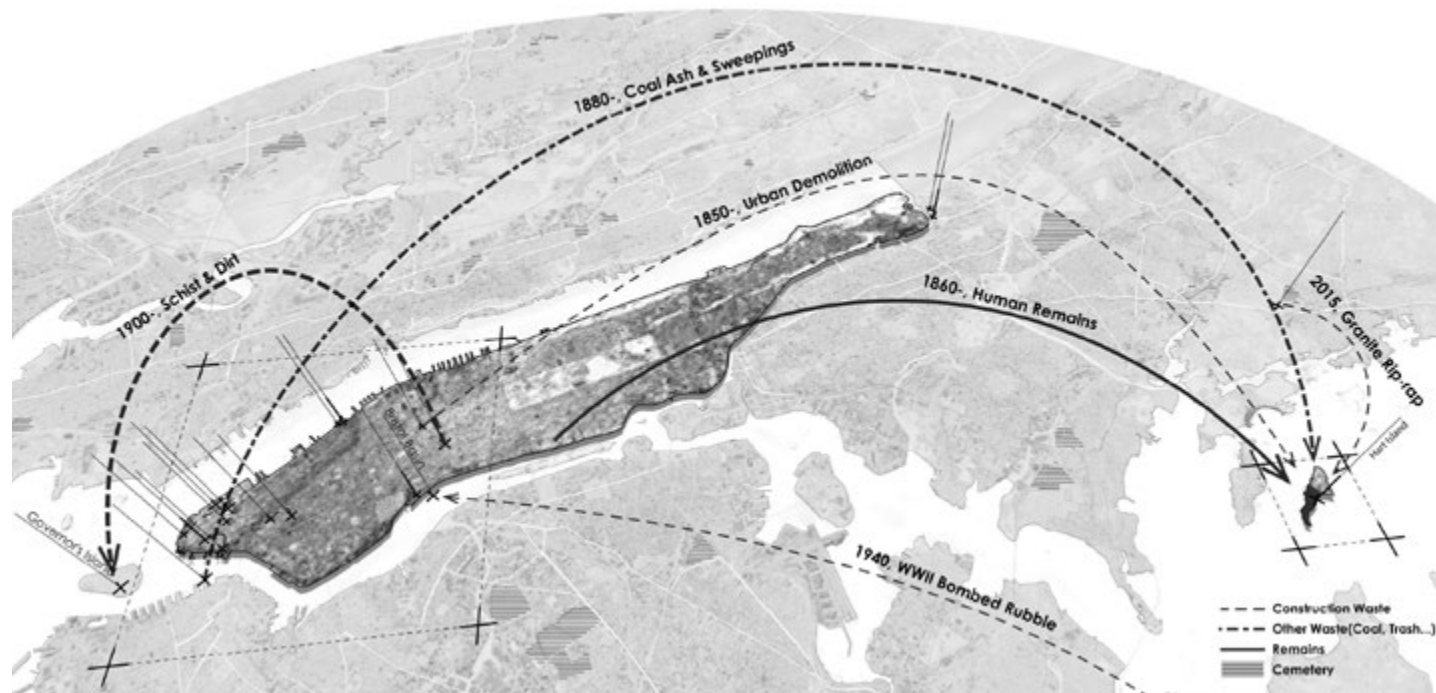
Rather than proposing a static architectural object, this project introduces a dynamic design mechanism to negotiate with the inherent instability of both the shifting coastal environment and the compromised built environment. By engaging with the continuous flow of disappearance and material presence, a new territorial infrastructure is established that bridges these two isolated realms. This reciprocal exchange reclaims stalled urban voids to process the deceased, transforming the narrative of mourning into an active ecological catalyst. Through the careful management of metabolic flows, the design aims to extend the legacy and history of burials, projecting the profound significance of death into a resilient future that sustains the city's most vulnerable landscapes.

Year: 2026

Type: GSAPP Studio Project (Group Work with Dajin Wang)

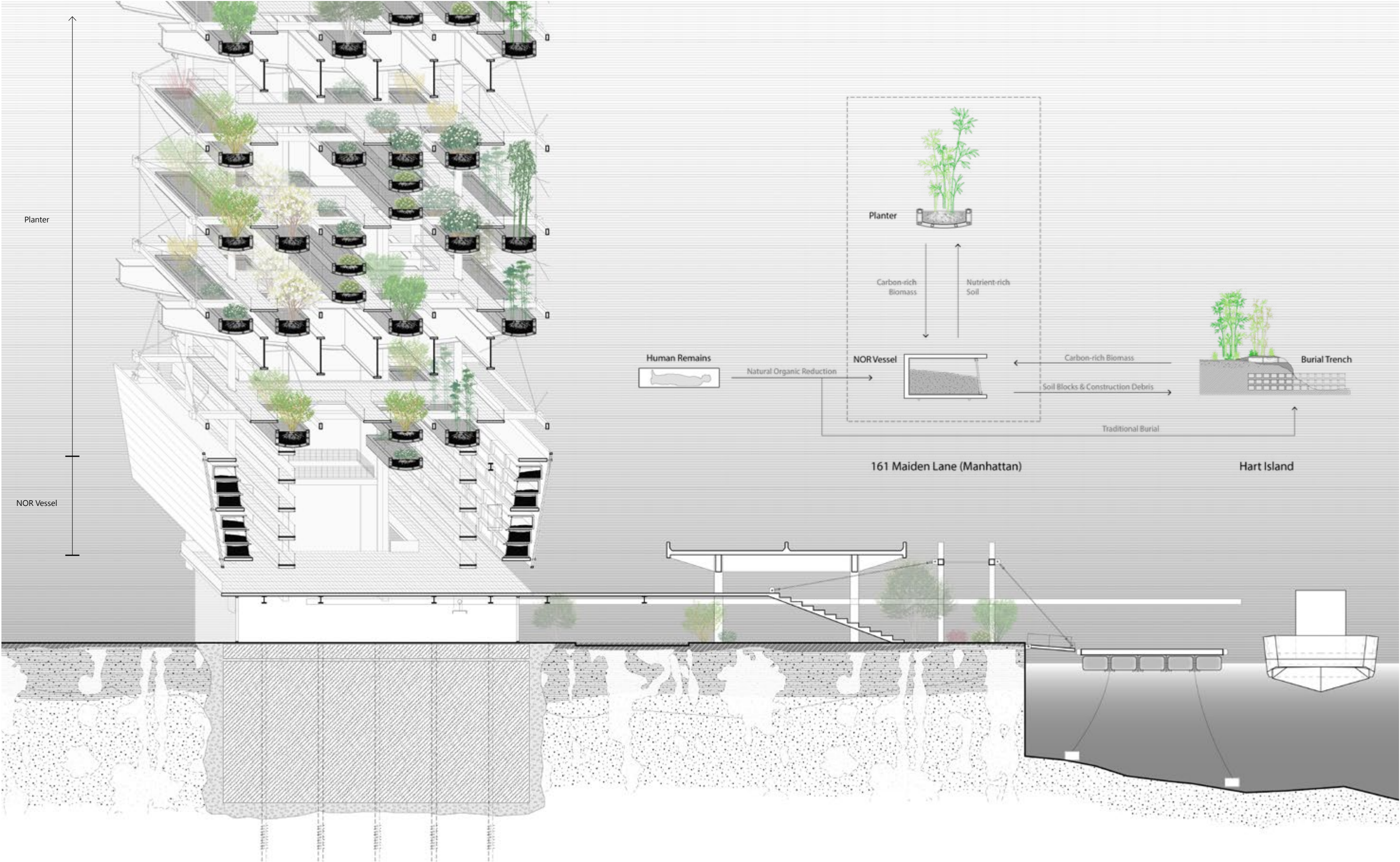
Location: New York, USA

Instructor: Karla Rothstein (Founder of DeathLAB & LATENT Productions)

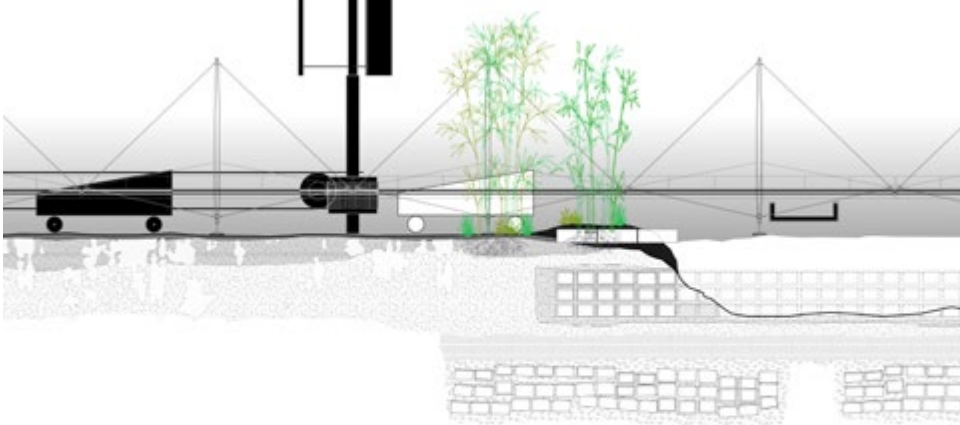
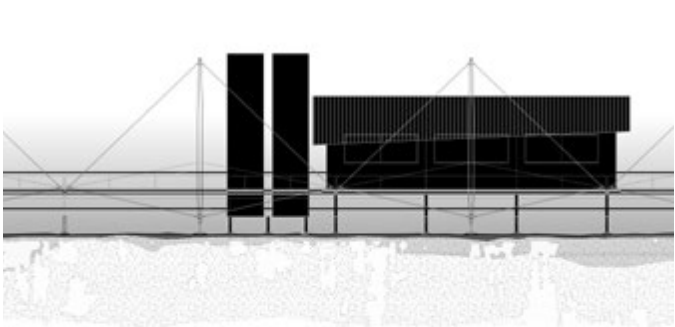
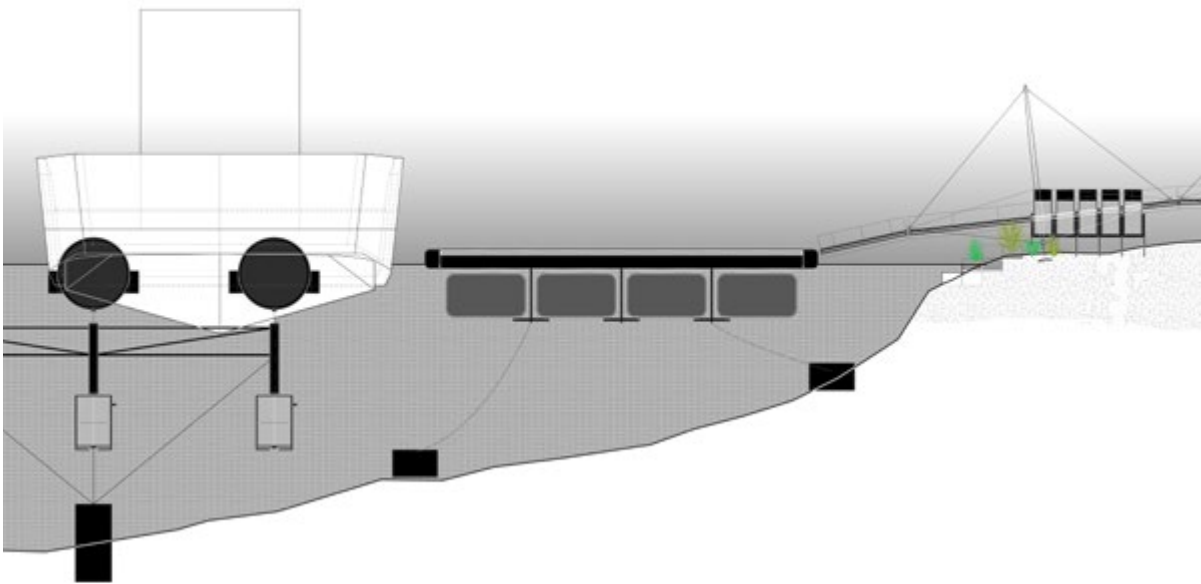
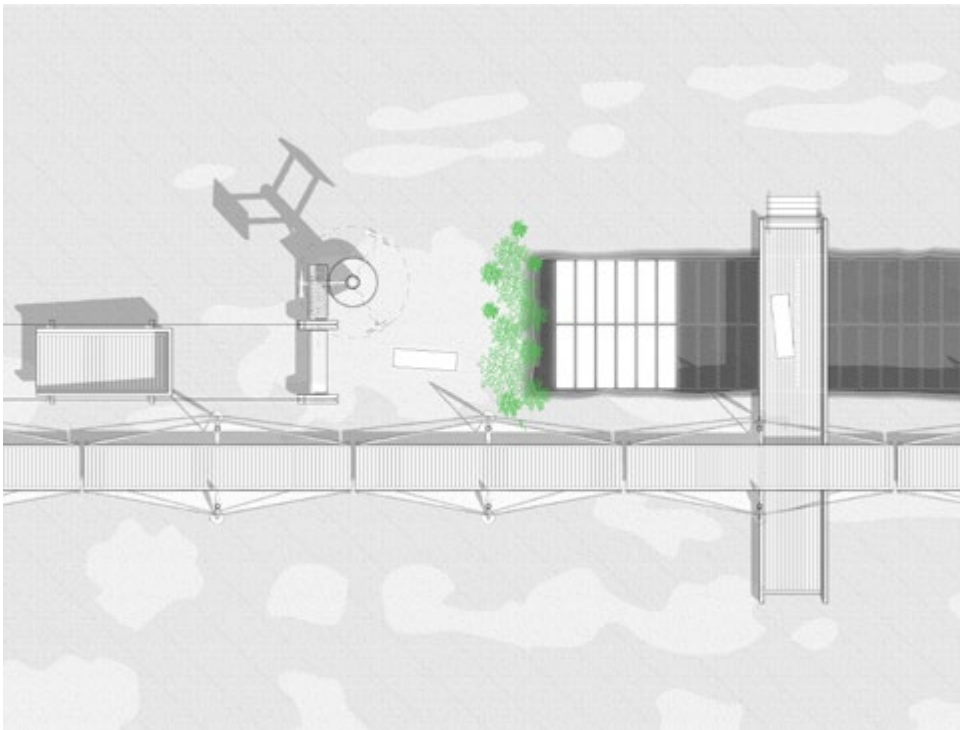
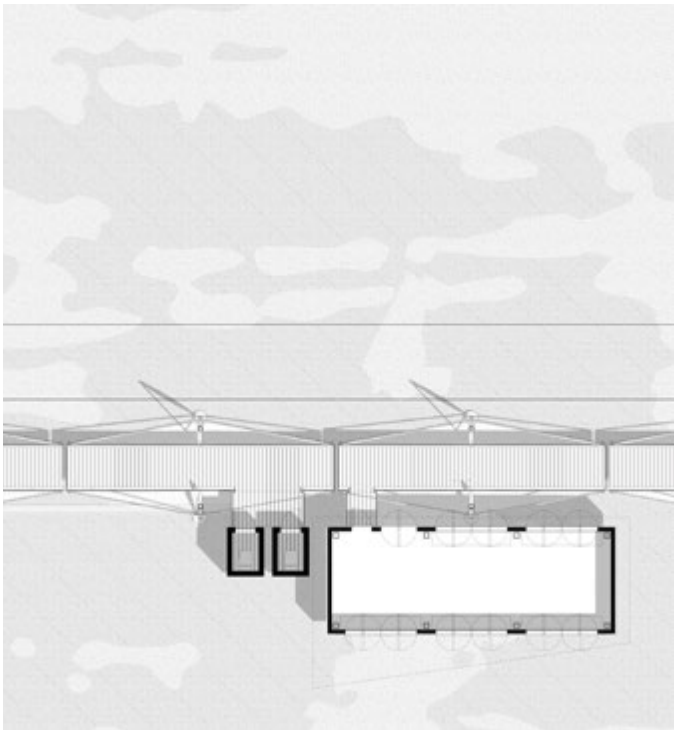


The Accumulation of Presence and Absence

Through material studies of salt, ink, and water, this project explores the dynamic process of disappearance rather than a static absence. Scaled territorially, this logic informs land reclamation and erosion. By mapping Hart Island's irregular trenches, the landscape is revealed as a continuous, living ledger of spatial transformation.



Hart Island Plan & Section

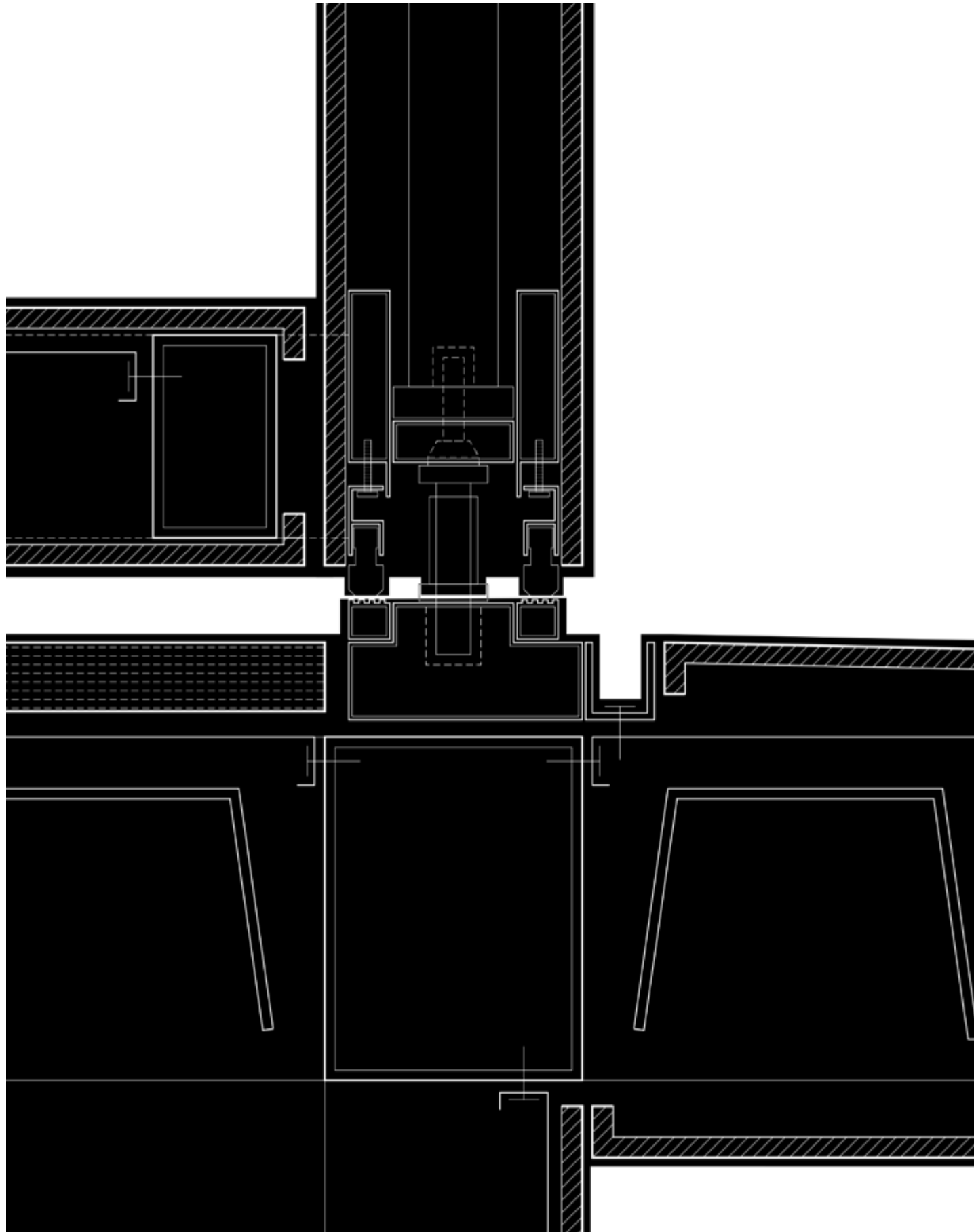


A Territorial Metabolism

This infrastructure envisions a new spatial paradigm. In Manhattan, the repurposed 161 Maiden Lane stands as a vertical, planted cemetery, reinstating mourning within the urban grid. Across the water, Hart Island is methodically fortified by imported soil, protecting its vulnerable shoreline and transforming its profound burial history into a continuous, evolving landscape.







A Darkroom inside a Room From Mask to Exposure

This project explores the dialectic of light and enclosure through a "box" situated between interior and exterior. Inspired by the duality of a mask—concealing while defining a face—the architecture functions as a mechanical apparatus.

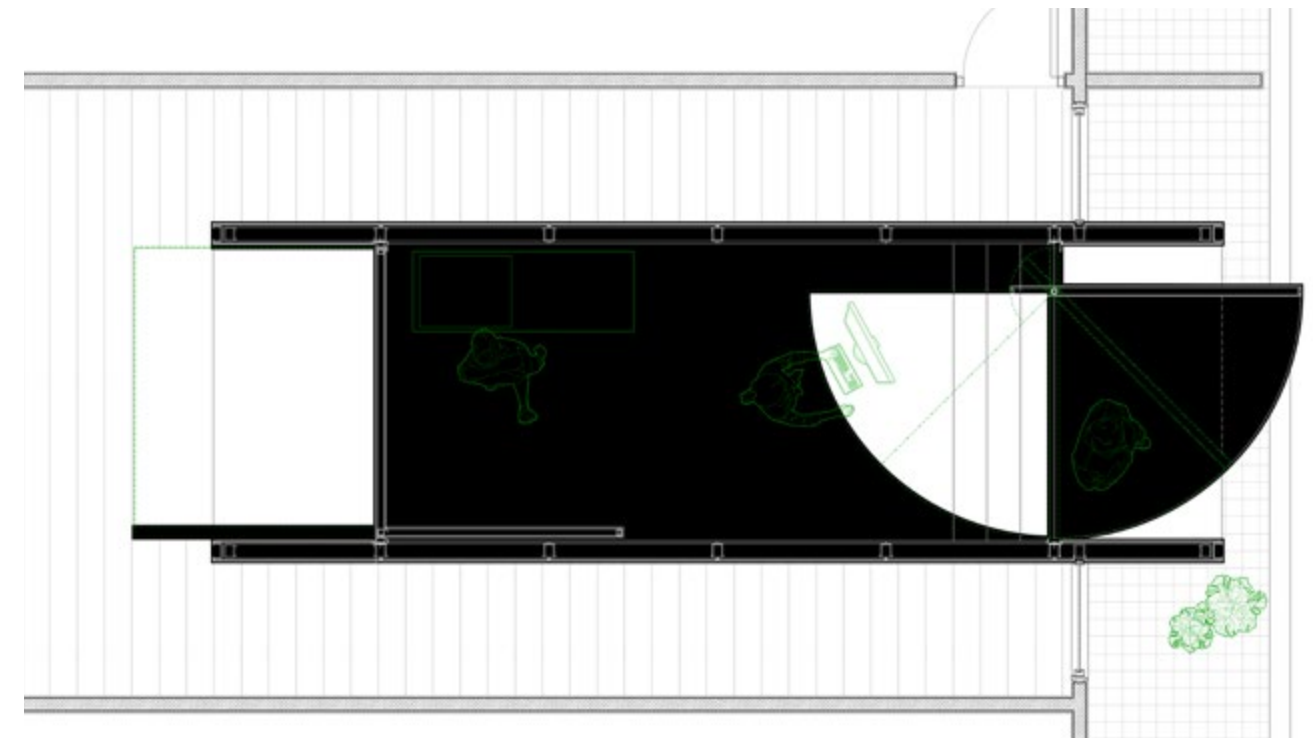
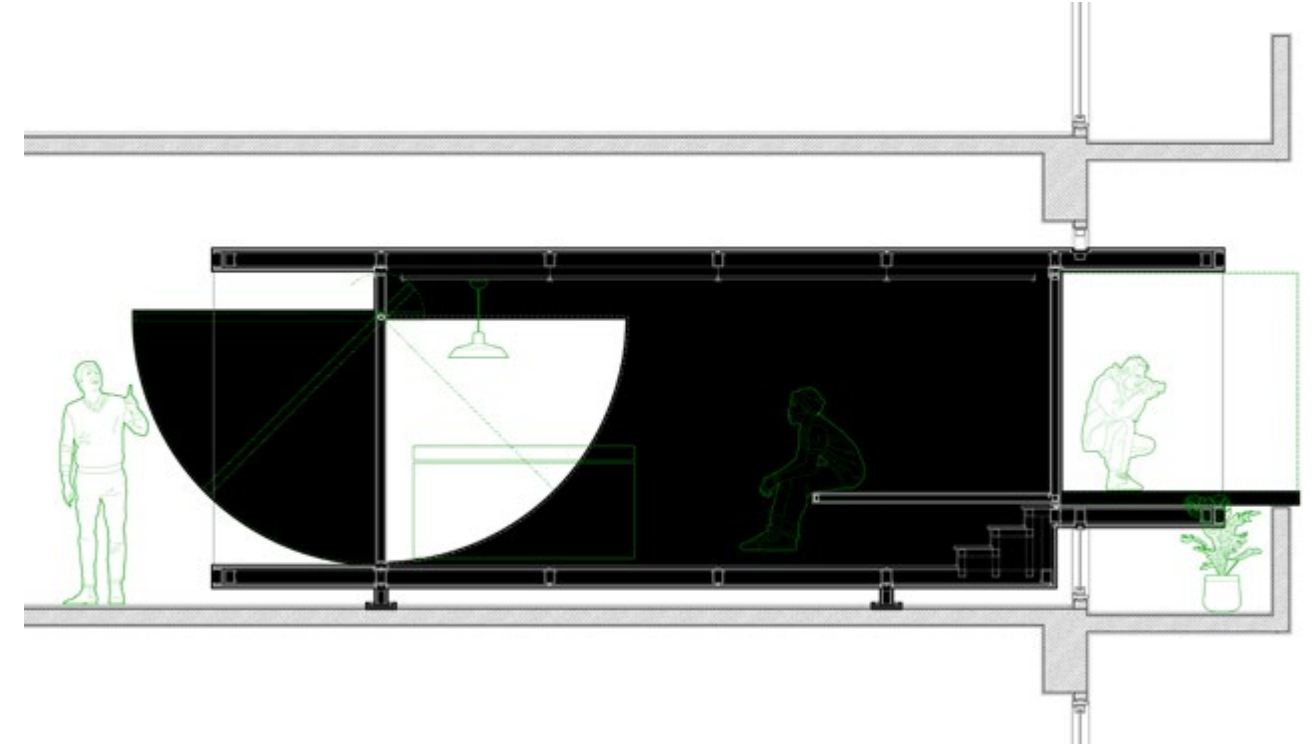
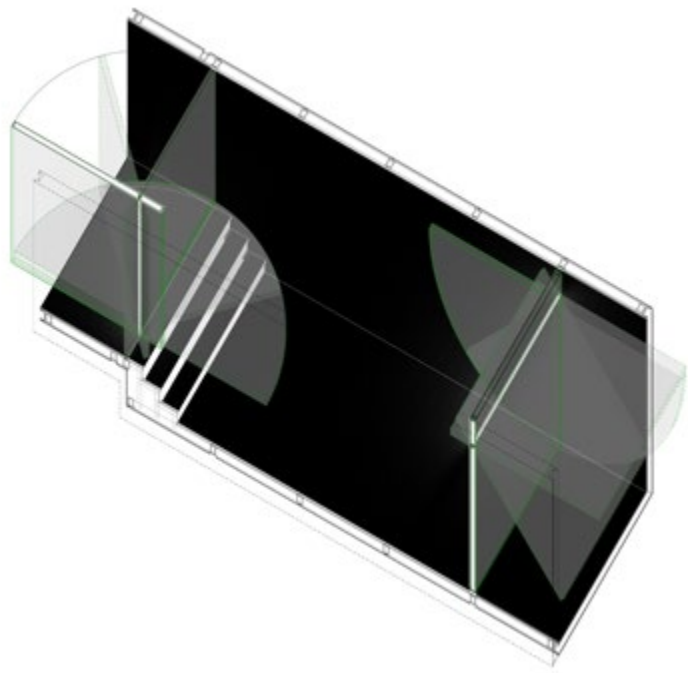
It begins as a sealed darkroom. Through the unfolding of its skin, the darkroom breathes, transforming from a hermetic void into a theater of exposure. The opening of the pivot door is not merely a functional act but a spatial event: the black interior expands to claim the exterior, while natural light penetrates to rewrite the room's atmosphere.

Year: 2025

Type: GSAPP Elective Project (Individual Work)

Location: Taipei, Taiwan

Instructor: Christoph Kumpusch

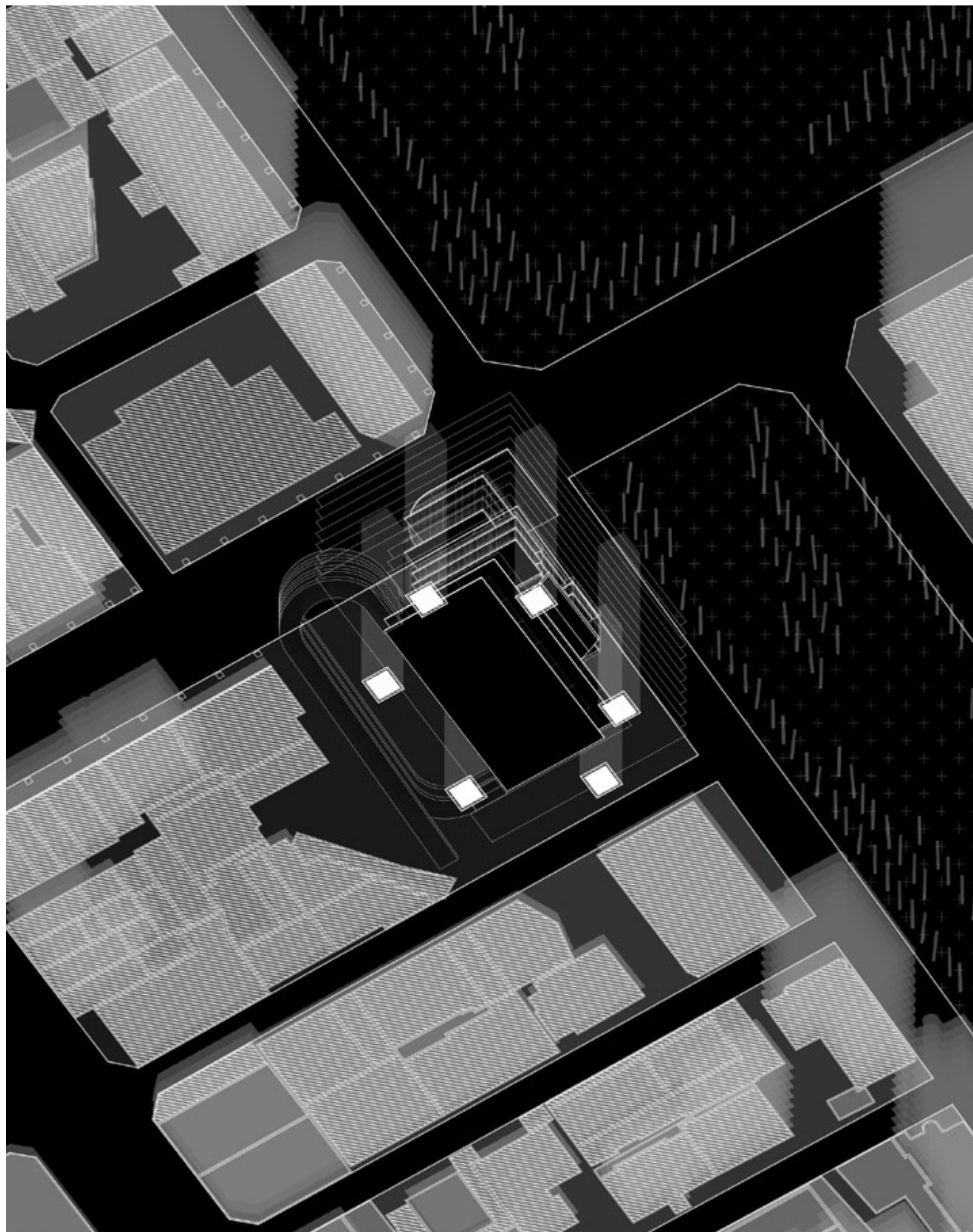


Cinematic Reference: The Terrorizers (1986)

Inspired by Edward Yang's depiction of Taipei's urban solitude, specifically the photographer's darkroom. The design translates the film's atmospheric tension—the drifting photographs, the sudden intrusion of light upon curtain opening, and the shifting boundaries between observer and observed—into an architectural mechanism. The room captures the precise moment when a sealed "darkness" is breached by the "brightness" of the city.

The Pivot & The Platform

Two kinetic elements renegotiate the boundary between darkroom and platform. The Pivot Door functions as a mask; its rotation is an act of "unmasking," projecting the black interior into the white exterior. The Unfolding Platform breaks the hermetic seal, extending the floor to create a semi-outdoor interface. Sharing identical geometric logic in plan and section—a rotating quarter-circle void—the design operates as a coherent machine for light control.



Super Public

A Prototype for the Privatized City

How Can Architecture Redefine the Threshold of Urban Publicness?

Under neoliberal-driven urban development, public space has been increasingly diminishing, gradually eroding the right to the city. This project addresses this issue by reinterpreting the modernist concept of pilotis (les pilotis) in the contemporary context, exploring how architecture can create new possibilities for urban rights. Located in Taichung's central business district, the design employs a minimized structural support system to liberate the ground plane, creating new public domains while stacking various public functions vertically to form a three-dimensional network of urban public spaces.

This strategy is not merely formal innovation but an active response to urban publicness and civic rights, attempting to redefine the relationship between architecture and urban democracy within privatized urban development.

Key themes

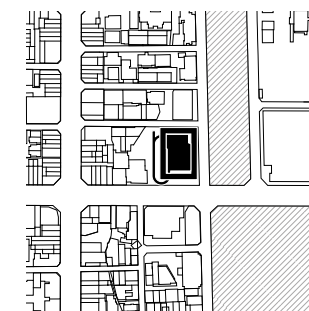
- Public-Private Interface
- Spatial Resistance
- Urban Democracy

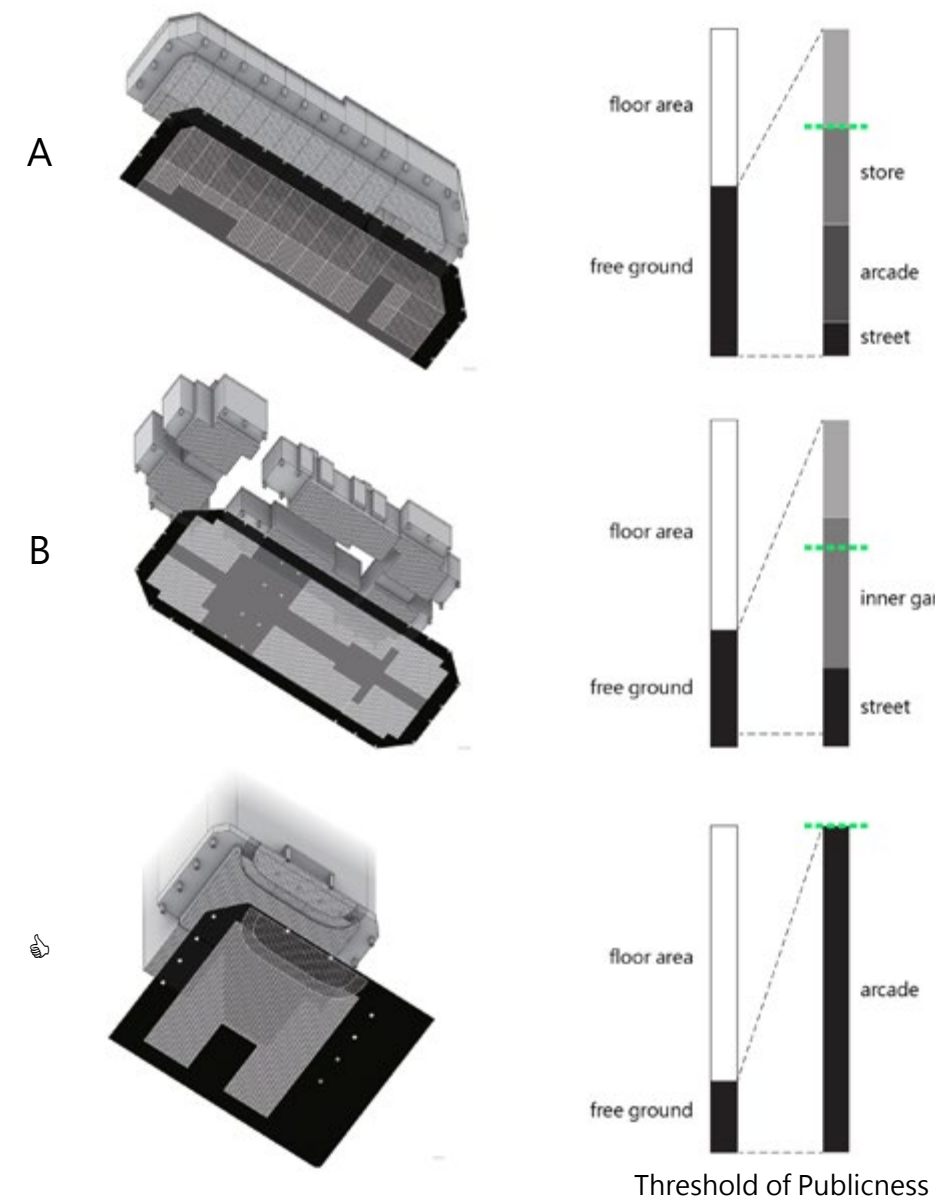
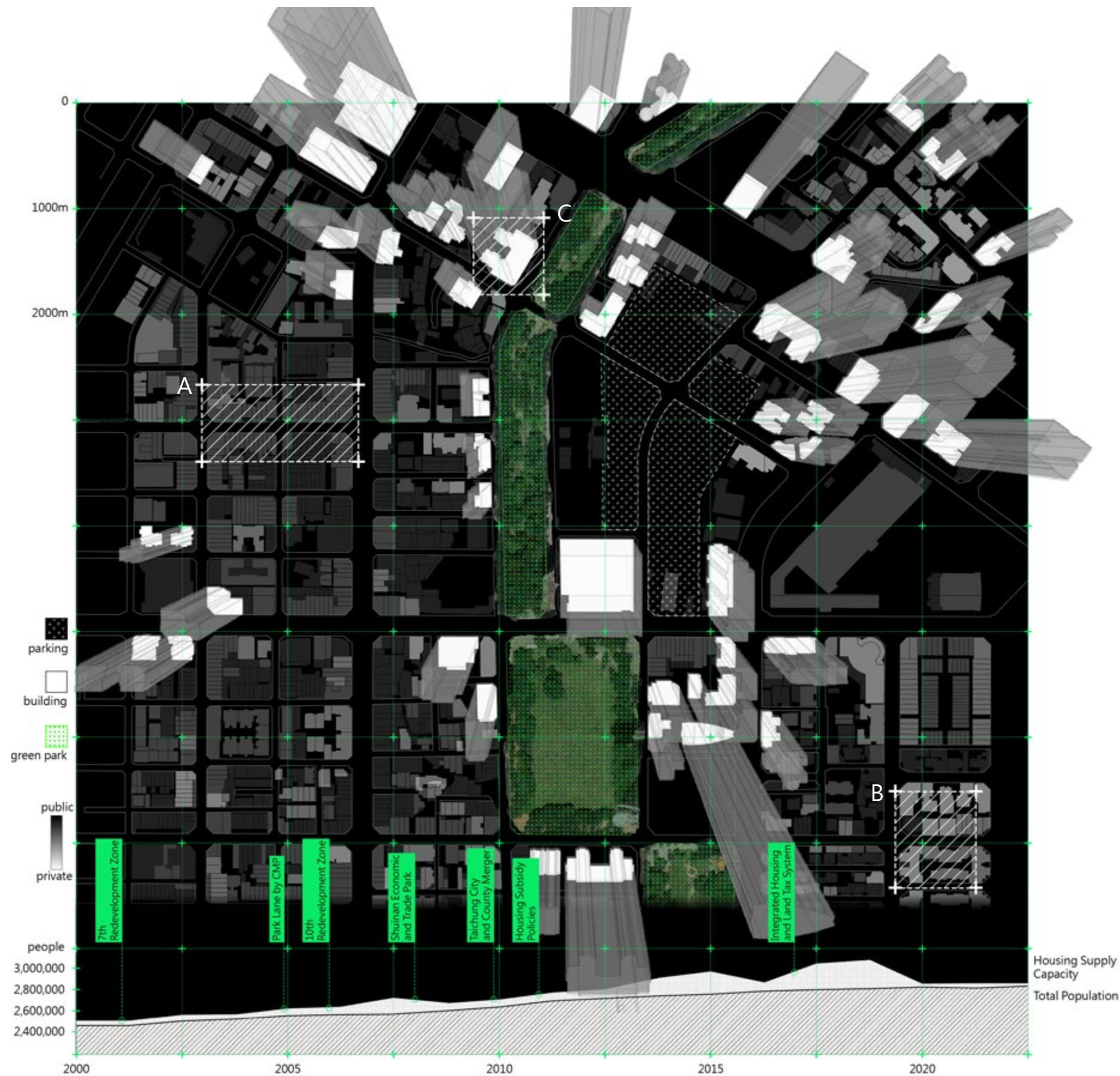
Year: 2018

Type: Studio Project (Individual Work)

Location: Taichung, Taiwan

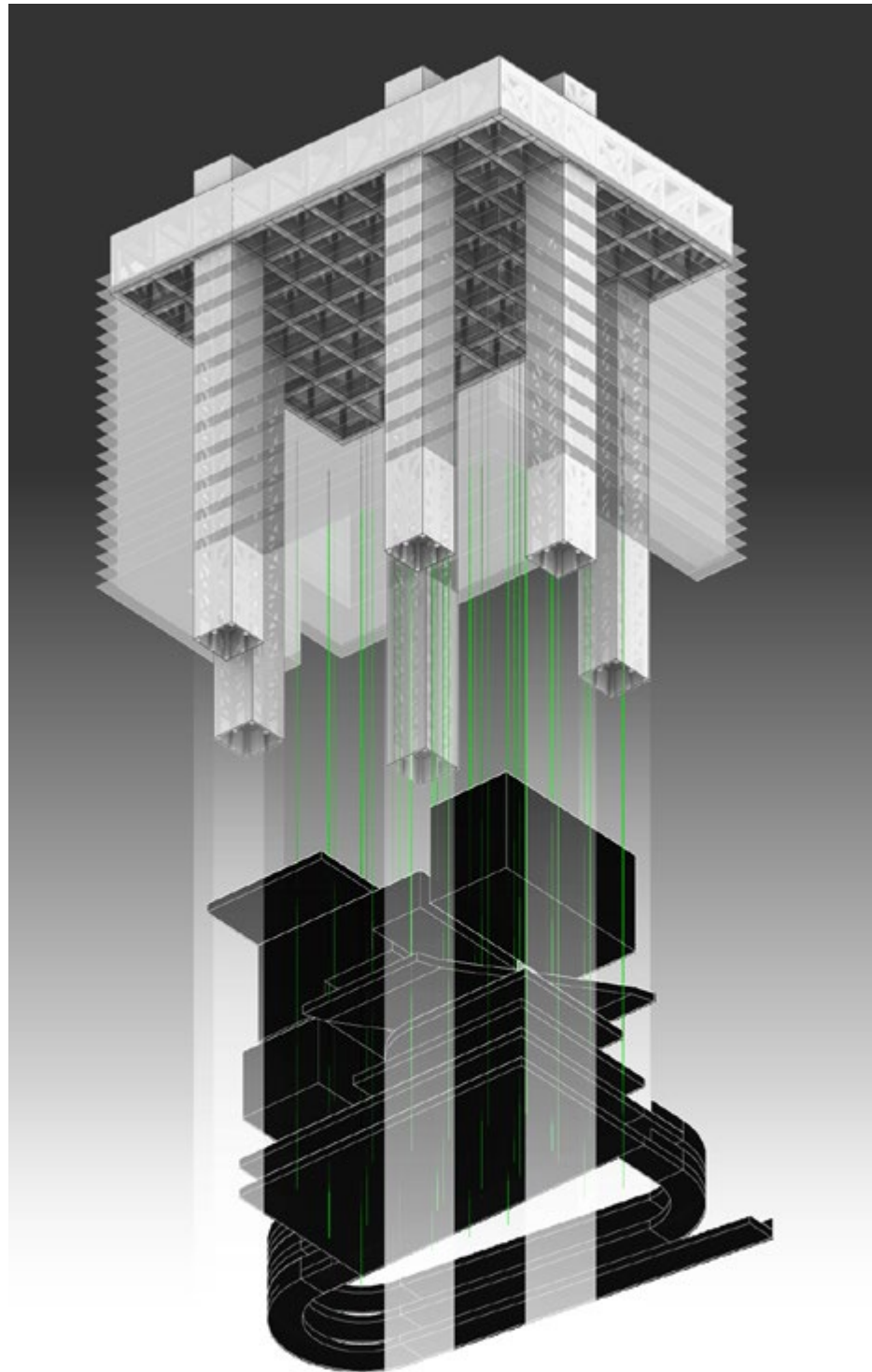
Instructor: Chia-Shun Liao





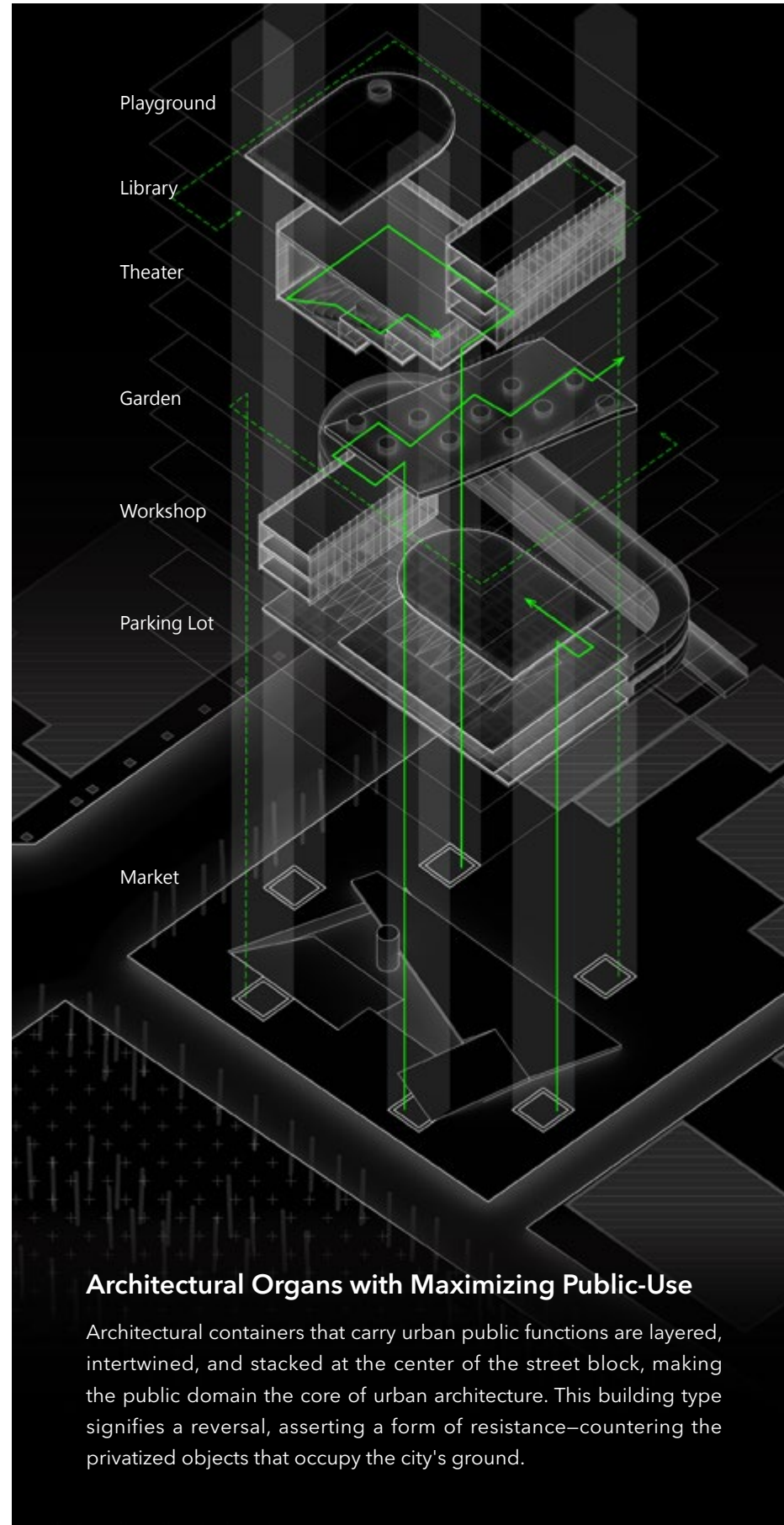
Toward a Private-Object City

As residential types evolve, not only has the intensity of building block usage increased, but the Floor Area Ratio (FAR) restrictions have also been relaxed, allowing more building floor area per unit of land. This shift has intensified the degree of building privatization, turning the once-rich gradations between public and private realms into stark, black-and-white separations. Consequently, the “objecthood” of urban buildings becomes increasingly pronounced, with these private objects occupying public spaces.



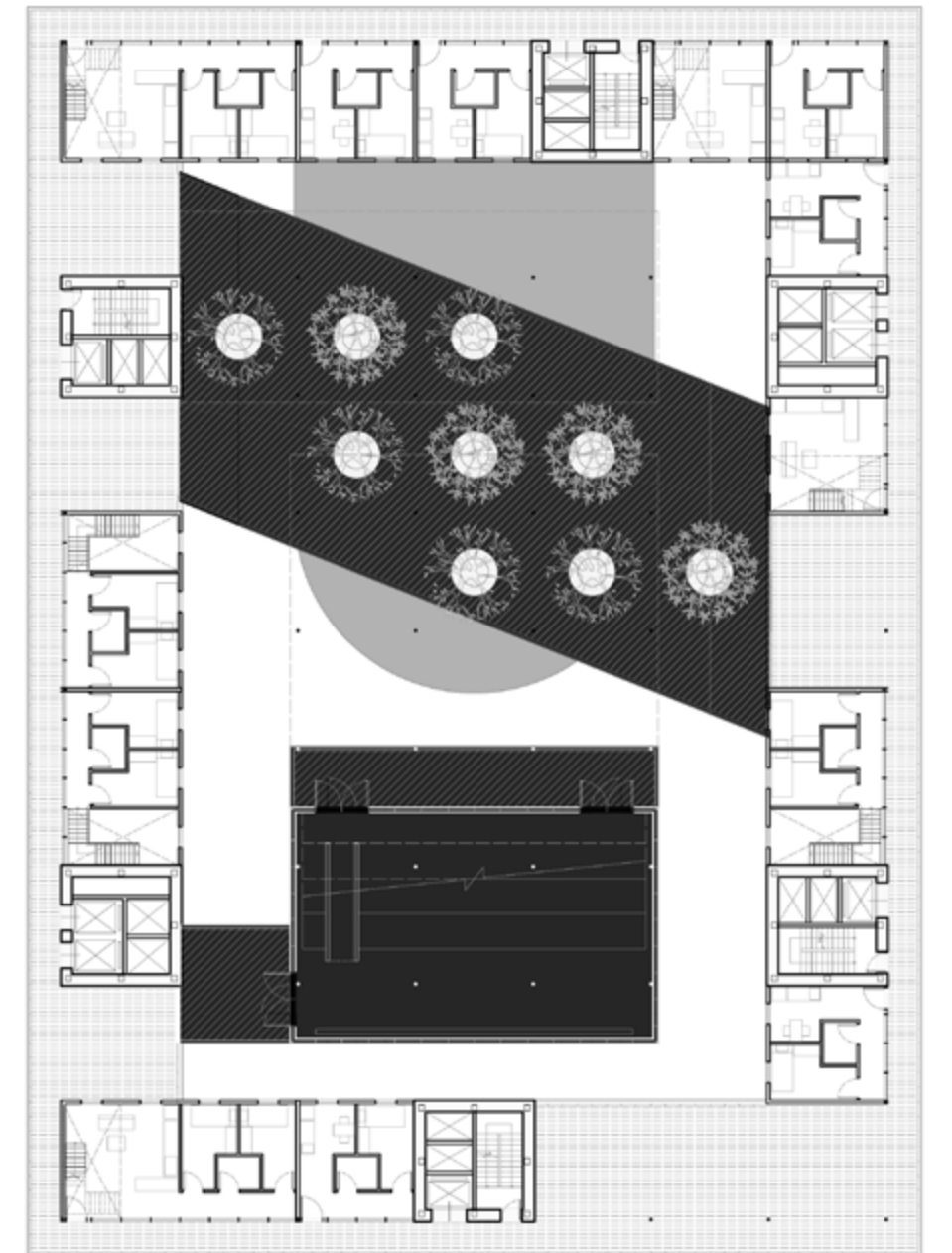
Structure with Minimal Ground Occupation

Six tubular structural supports are the only architectural elements in contact with the ground, lifting the top truss structure, from which all residential and public spaces are suspended. By occupying the ground minimally, this design creates a free ground that allows for uninterrupted passage of all urban activities.



Architectural Organs with Maximizing Public-Use

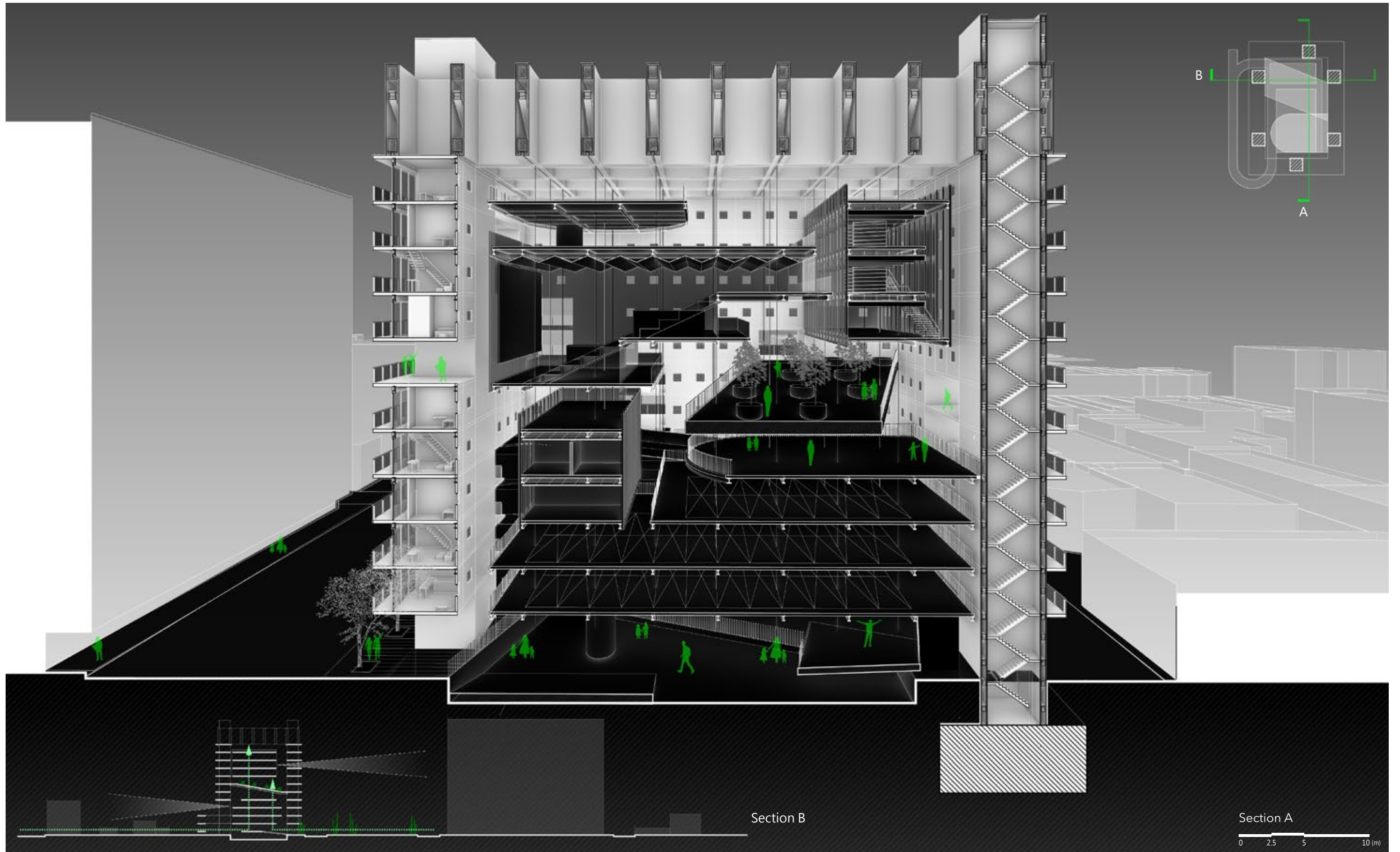
Architectural containers that carry urban public functions are layered, intertwined, and stacked at the center of the street block, making the public domain the core of urban architecture. This building type signifies a reversal, asserting a form of resistance—countering the privatized objects that occupy the city's ground.

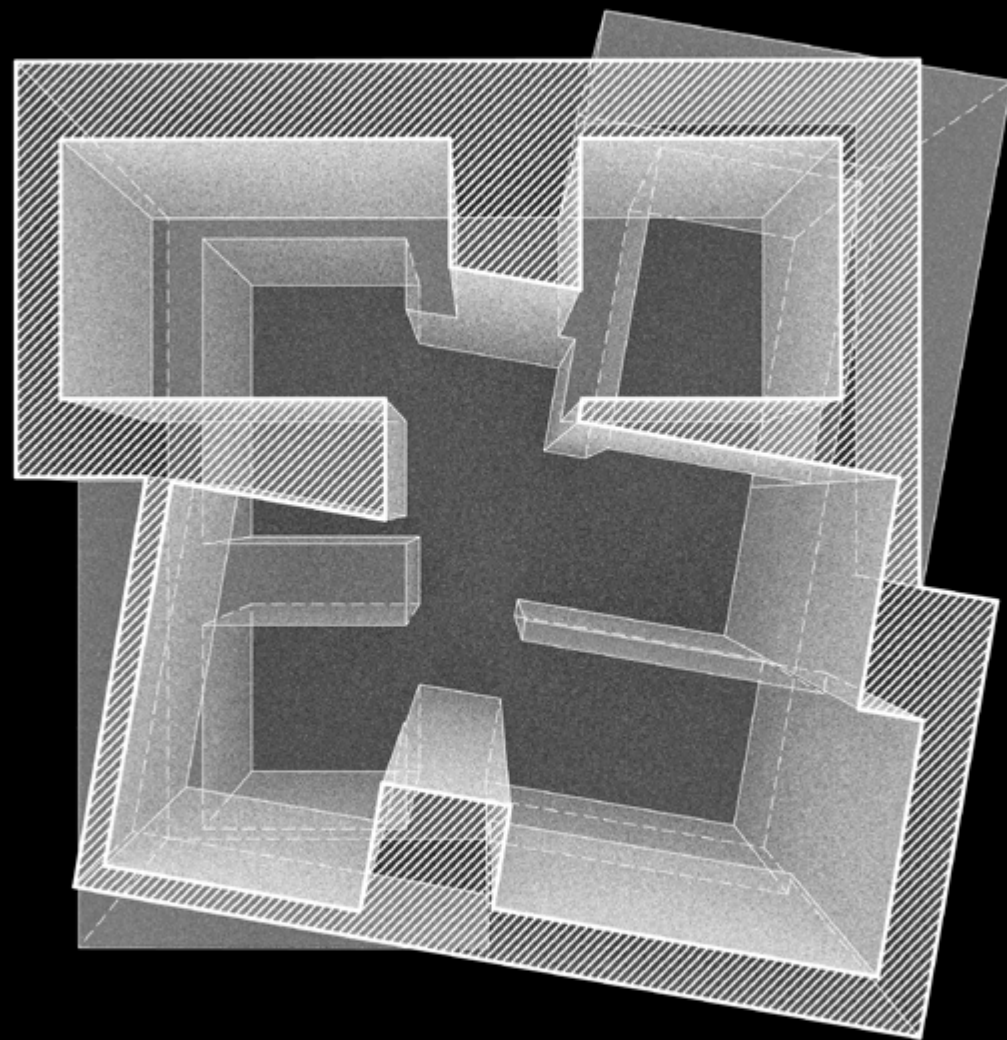


L7 Theater&Garden
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Facade Projecting Scenes of Life

An array of organic and diverse life scenes unfolds between facade layers of varying visual transparency, projecting nuanced relationships between public and private realms. From the exterior inward, the sequence progresses through public corridors, semi-transparent glass facades of residential units, and inter-floor openings that reveal the core public function volumes. With the ebb and flow of day and night and the movement of people, a cinematic montage of urban life continuously plays out across this facade.





Learning from the Earthworks Thickness Meets Temperature

How Does Climate Become Architecture?

In modern construction logic's pursuit of building performance, tactile experience and microclimate perception of the human body are often overlooked. This project reexamines the embodied wisdom in traditional rammed earth architecture, studying how it creates rich tactile experiences and comfortable microclimates through material properties and constructional details.

Taking Turpan region as the site, through precise analysis of temperature-time curves and integration of modern prefabrication technology with traditional methods, the project develops a new type of sustainable architecture that responds to human sensory needs at different scales. From the tactile properties of materials to the regulation of spatial microclimates, it reestablishes the direct connection between architecture and the user's body.

Key themes

- Material Performance
- Climate Response
- Tactile

Year: 2019

Type: Studio Project (Group research/Individual Work)

Location: Turpan, China

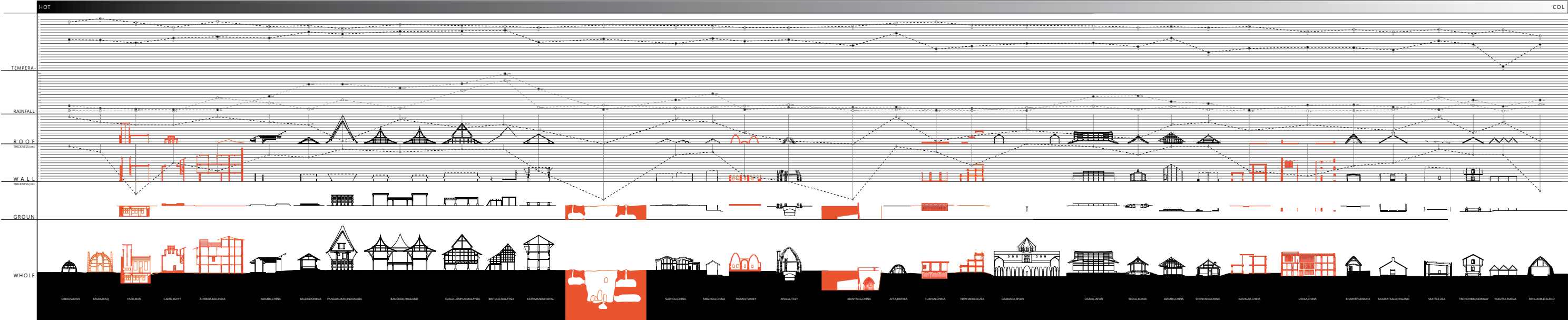
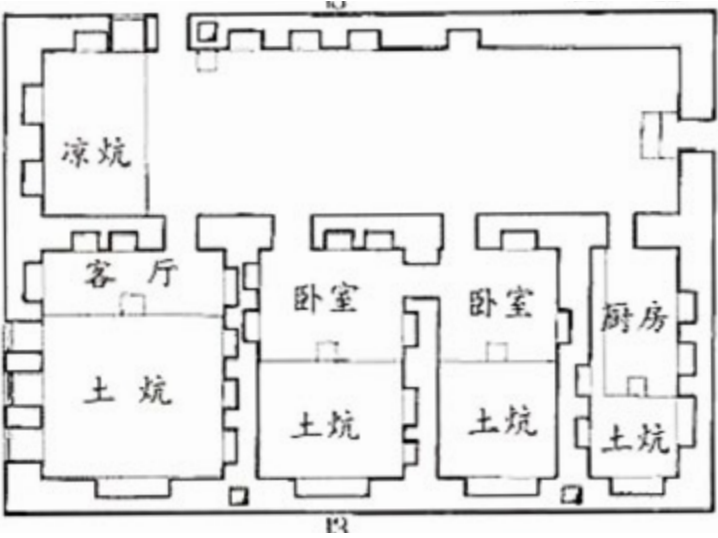
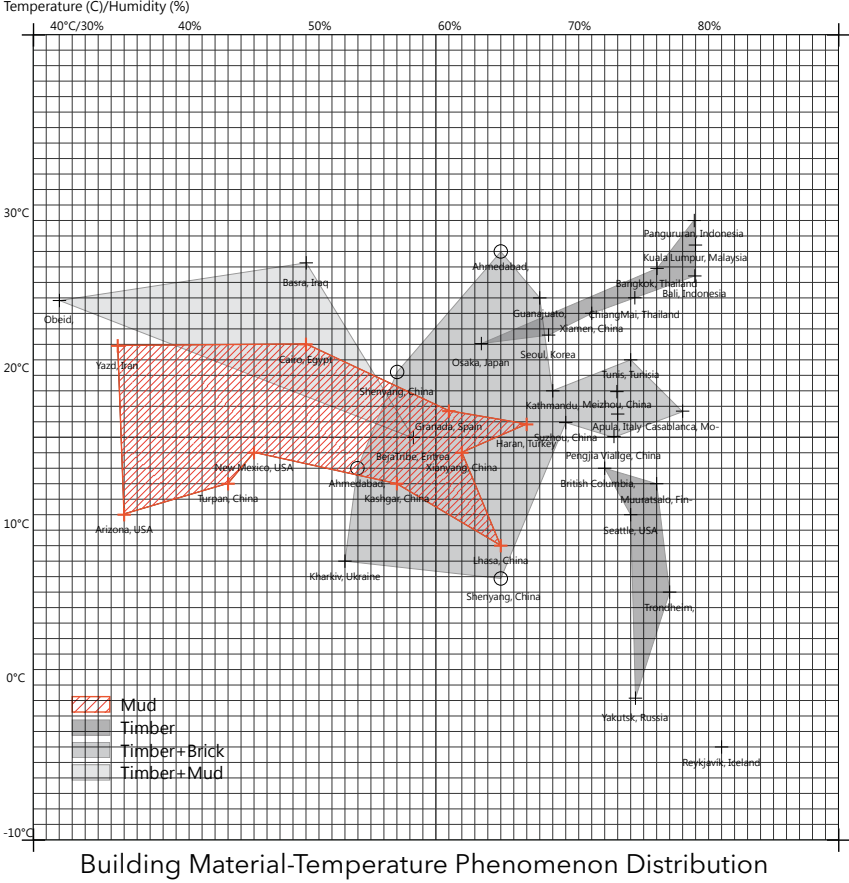
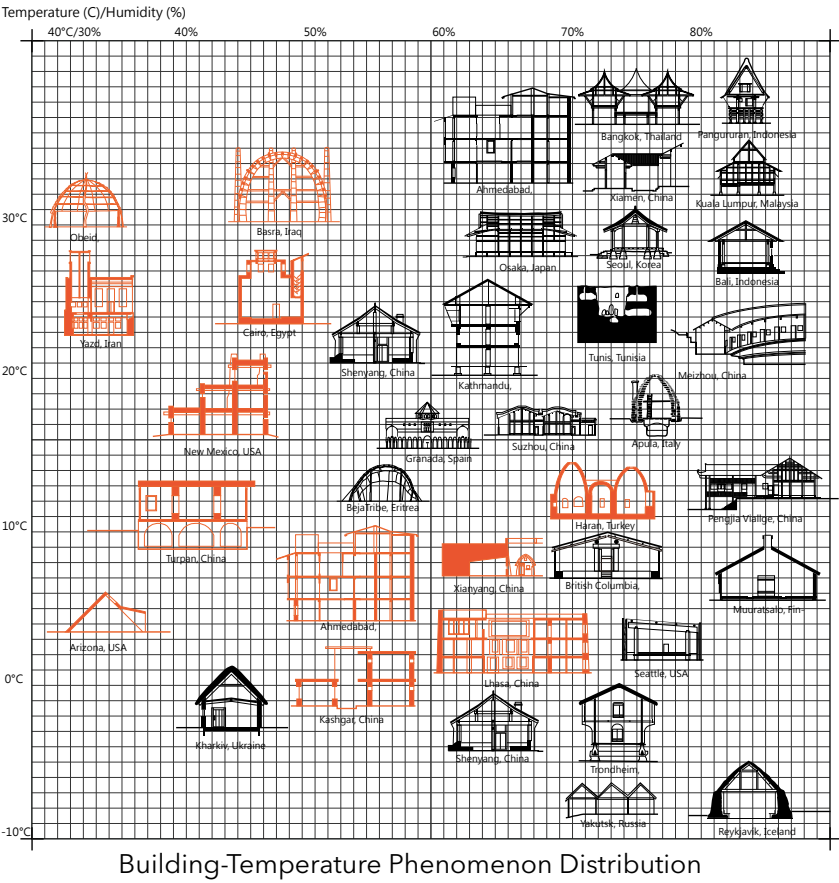
Instructor: Chia-Shun Liao

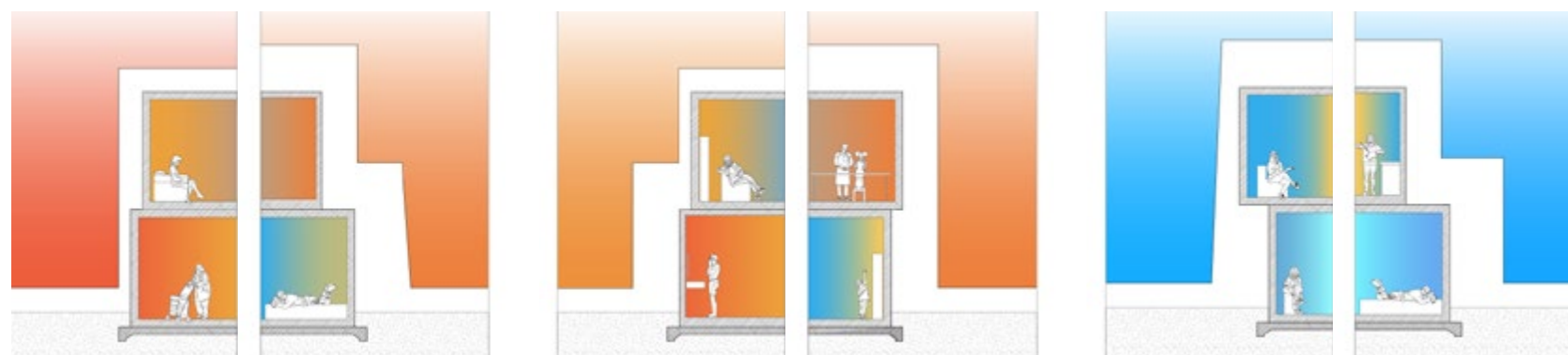
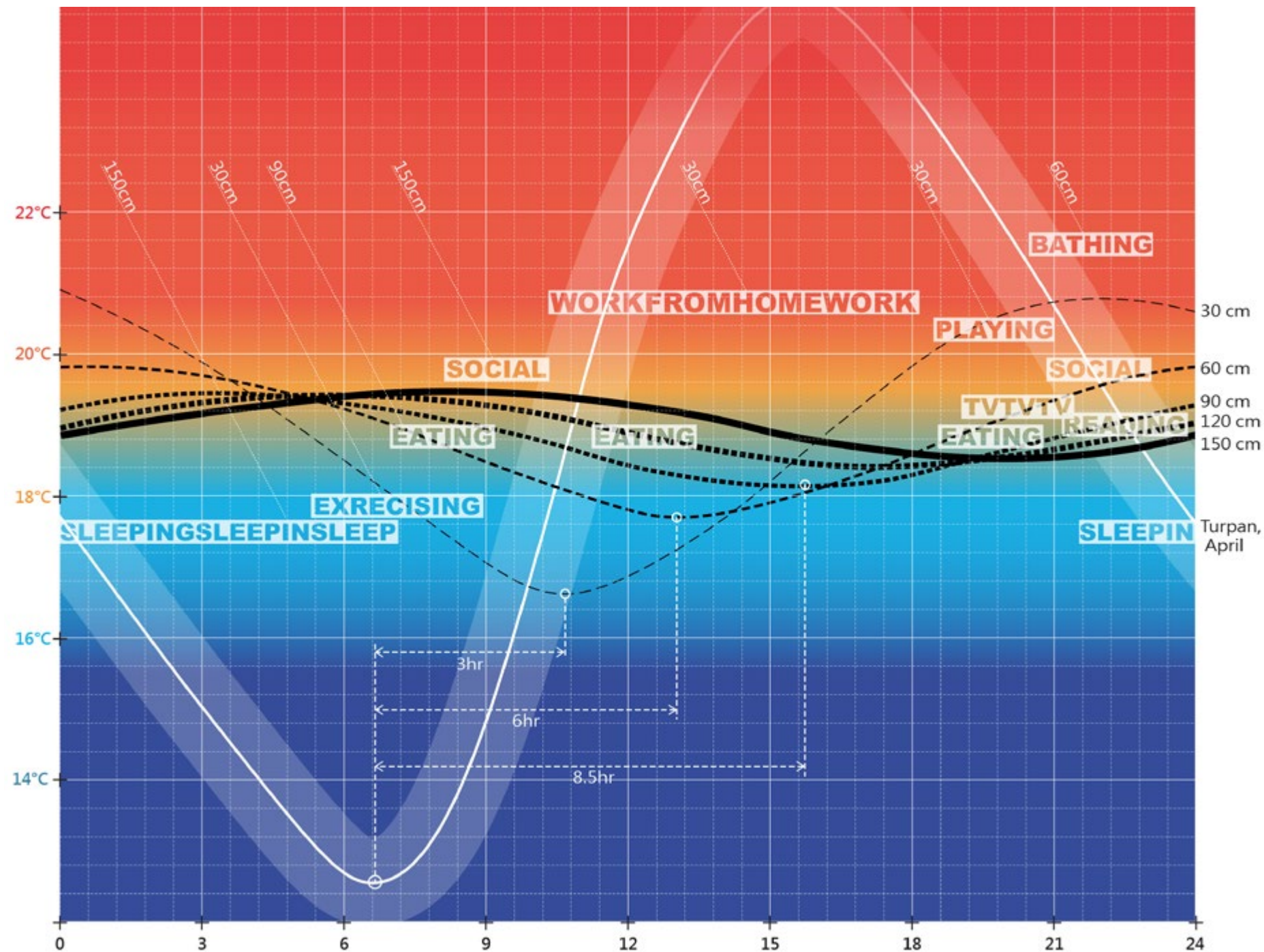


Index of Global Climate and Vernacular Architecture

Team Contribution: In charge of research, conceptual development, and sectional documentation

This studio begins with the relationship between climate and architectural typologies. It identifies representative traditional architectural samples from global climatic typologies and categorizes them based on the distribution of building forms, materials, and climatic conditions such as temperature and humidity.





Section A

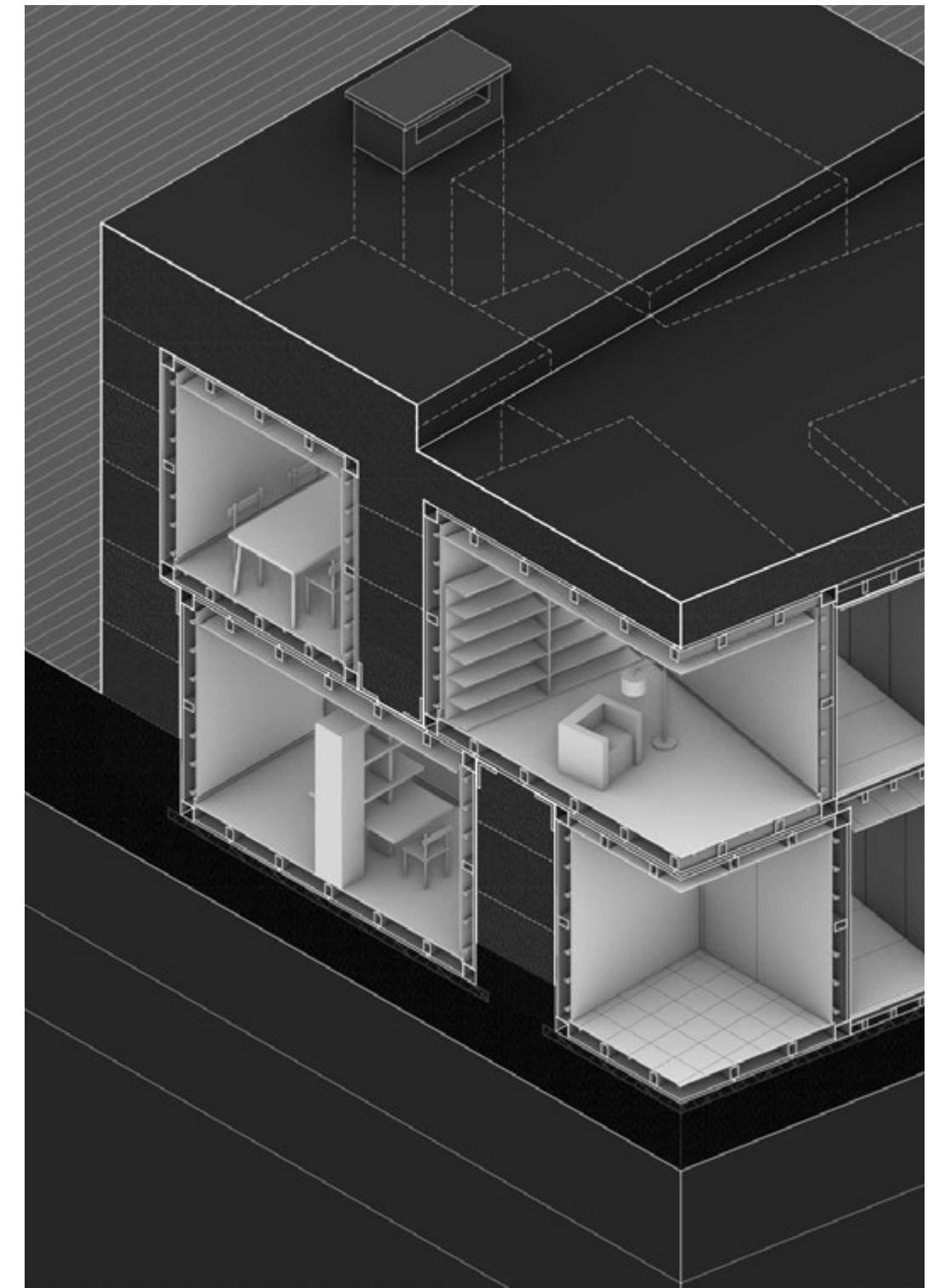
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Section B

22:00

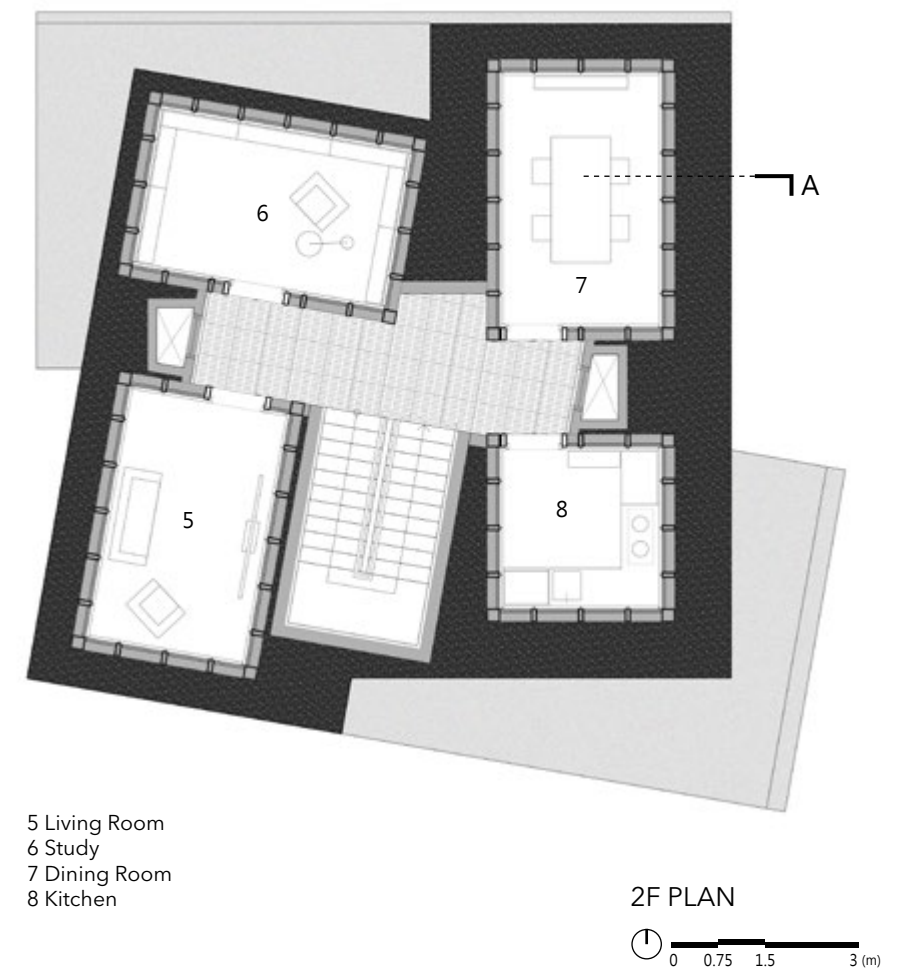
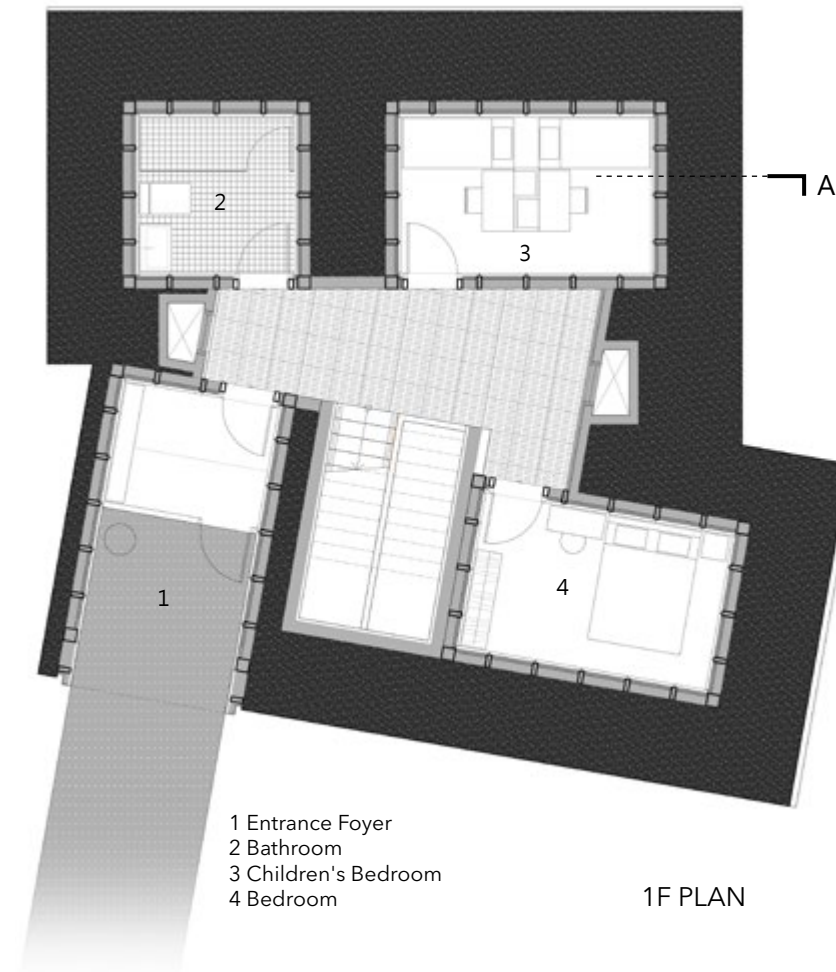
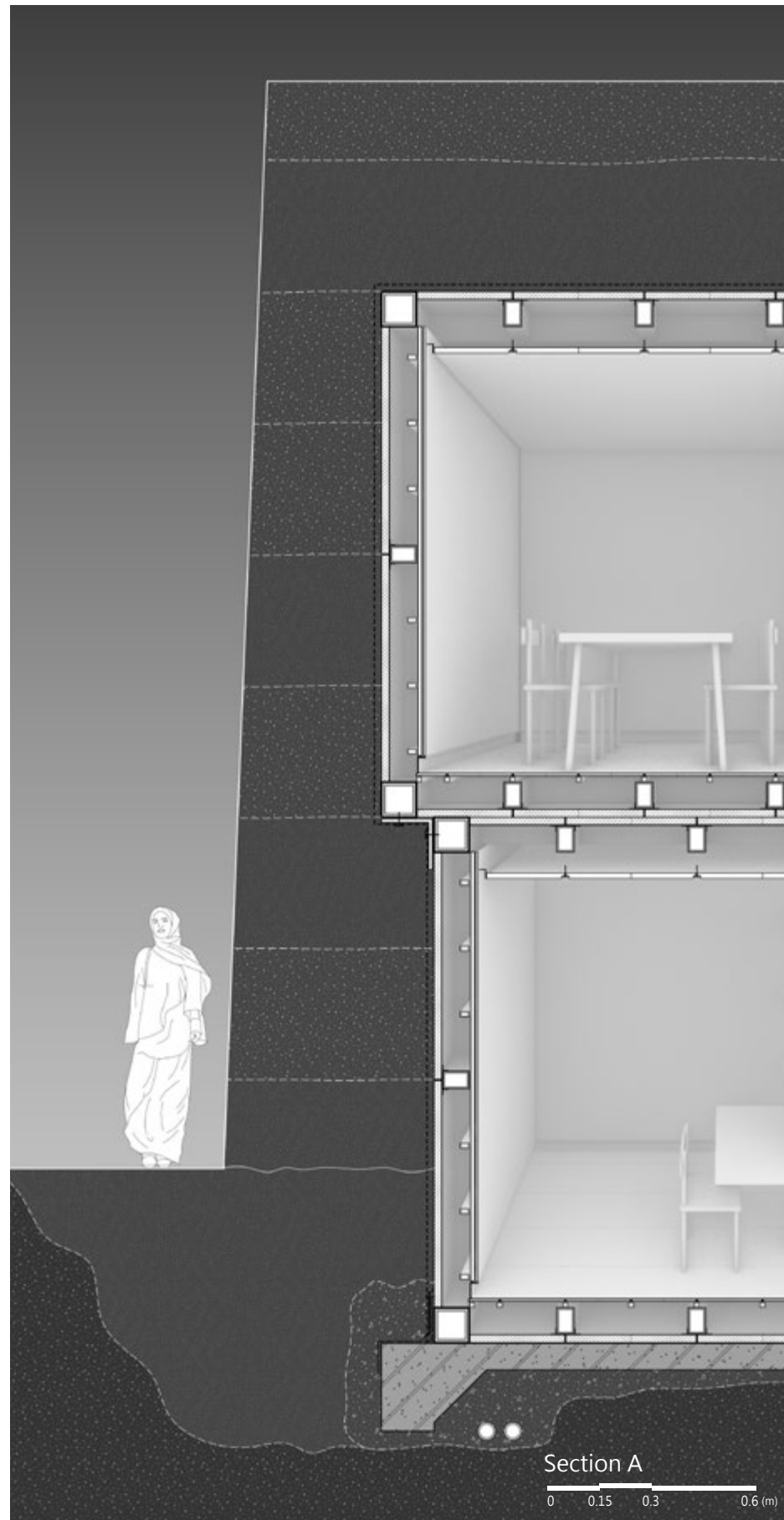
Section C

02:00



Form Follows Temperature

By overlaying the thermal lag curves of rammed earth onto daily human activity schedules, the design precisely defines the required wall thickness for each function. Thicker walls delay the heat transfer, creating a new vernacular typology: a responsive architecture where varying thicknesses not only optimize thermal comfort but also curate a distinct tactile experience for the human body.





The Albedo Archive

Architecture as Registering and Disclosure

Can architecture transcend pure science to become a vehicle for geopolitical accountability?

This project is about the Albedo Effect and Dust in the Arctic, viewing it as an interaction between color and temperature. When dark dust falls on the white Arctic ice, it absorbs heat and causes the ice to melt, creating new topographies and landscapes. Following the measurement of dust, the proposal shifts from pure scientific observation to the logistics of preservation and transportation.

The design investigates how this collected dust is not only measured but also preserved, archived, and physically transported out of the Arctic context to disclose the hidden natural and political genealogy of these particles. An "Outpost" is first used to collect data in the Arctic, and then this data is sent back to the sources of pollution by the Archive as a design statement

Key themes

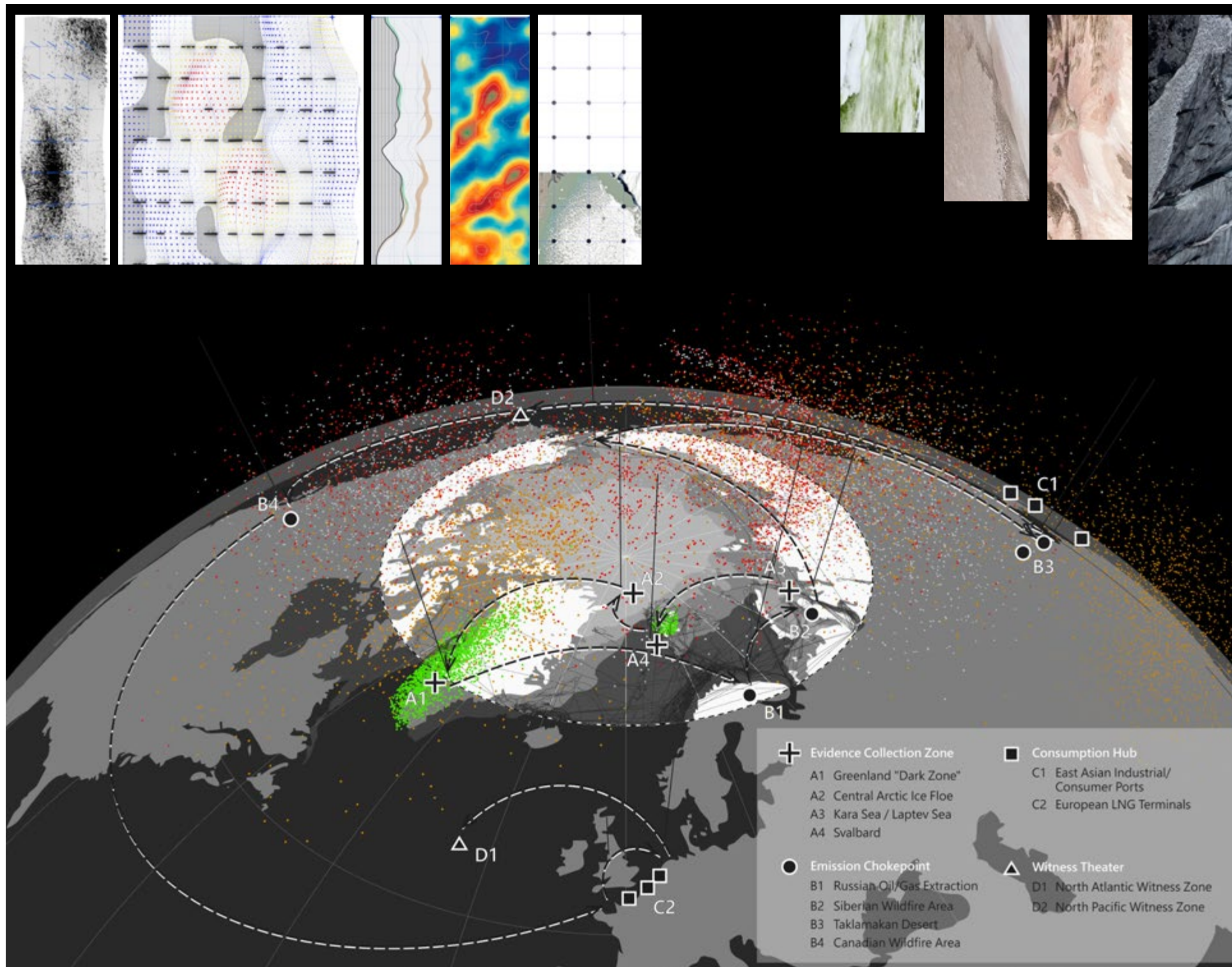
- Measuring
- Changing Landscape
- Geopolitics

Year: 2025

Type: GSAPP Studio Project (Individual Work)

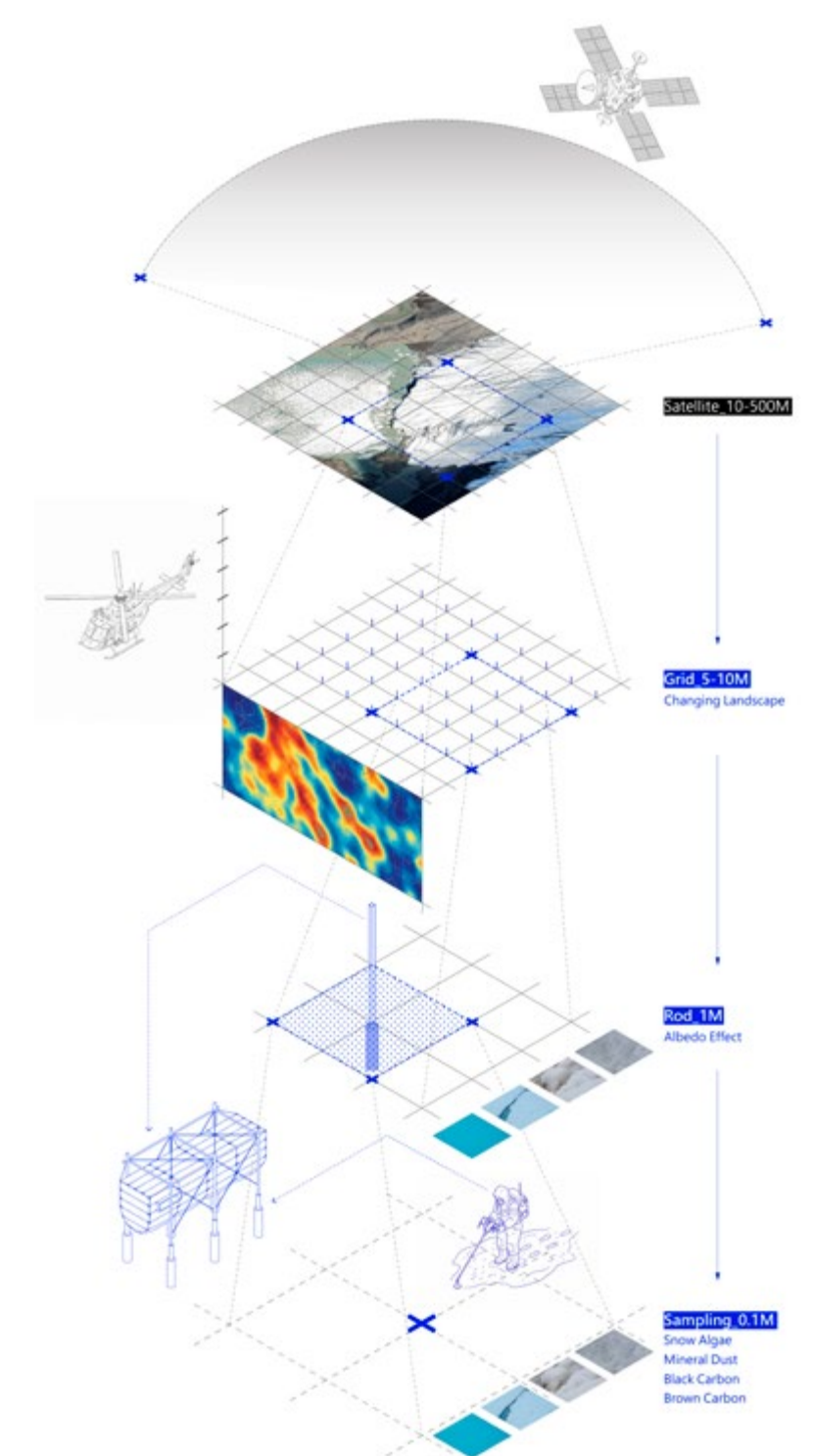
Location: Arctic

Instructor: Leslie Gill, Khoi Nguyen



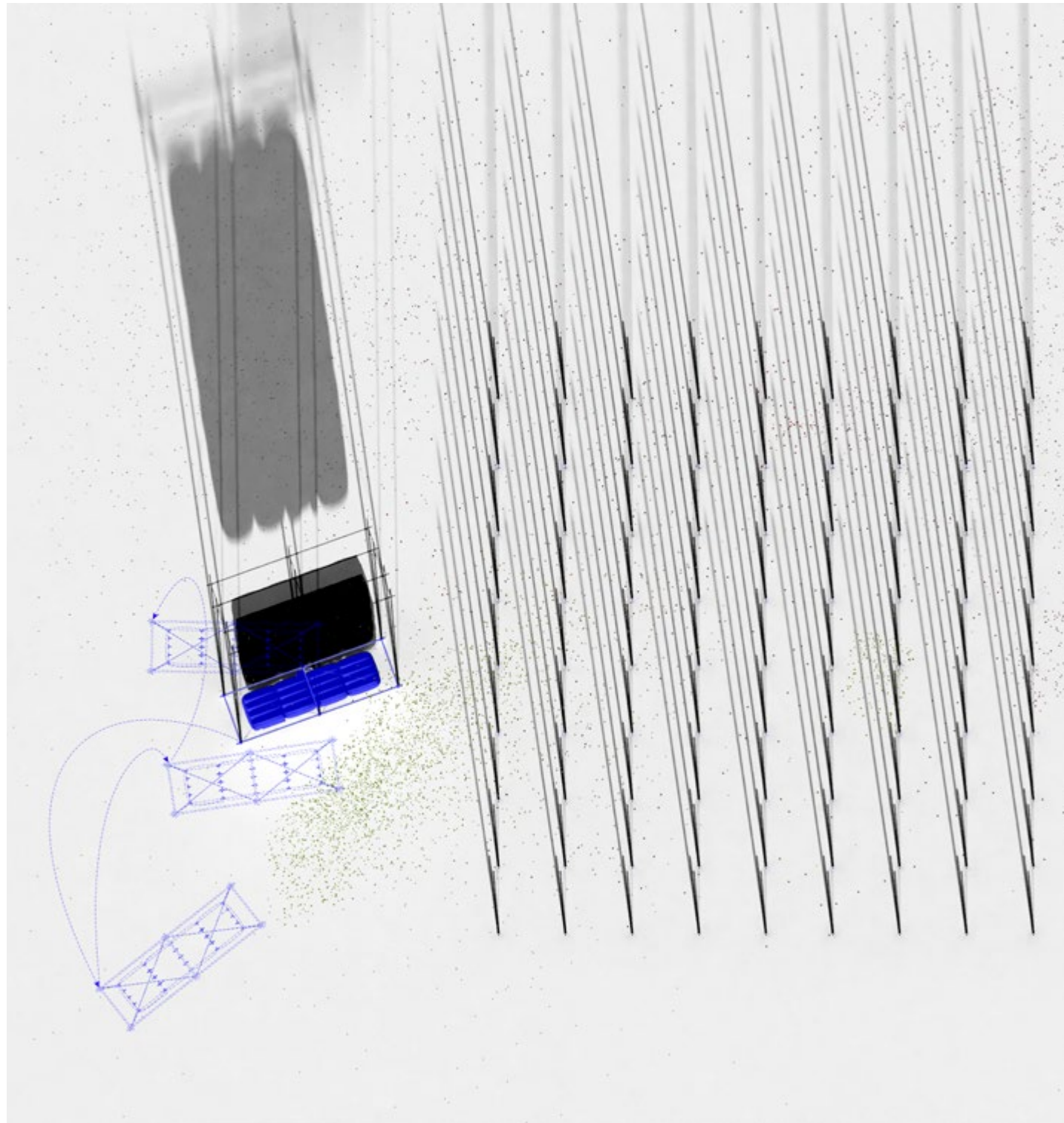
Albedo & Dust

This project is about the Albedo Effect and Dust in the Arctic, viewing it as an interaction between color and temperature. When dark dust falls on the white Arctic ice, it absorbs heat and causes the ice to melt, creating new topographies and landscapes.



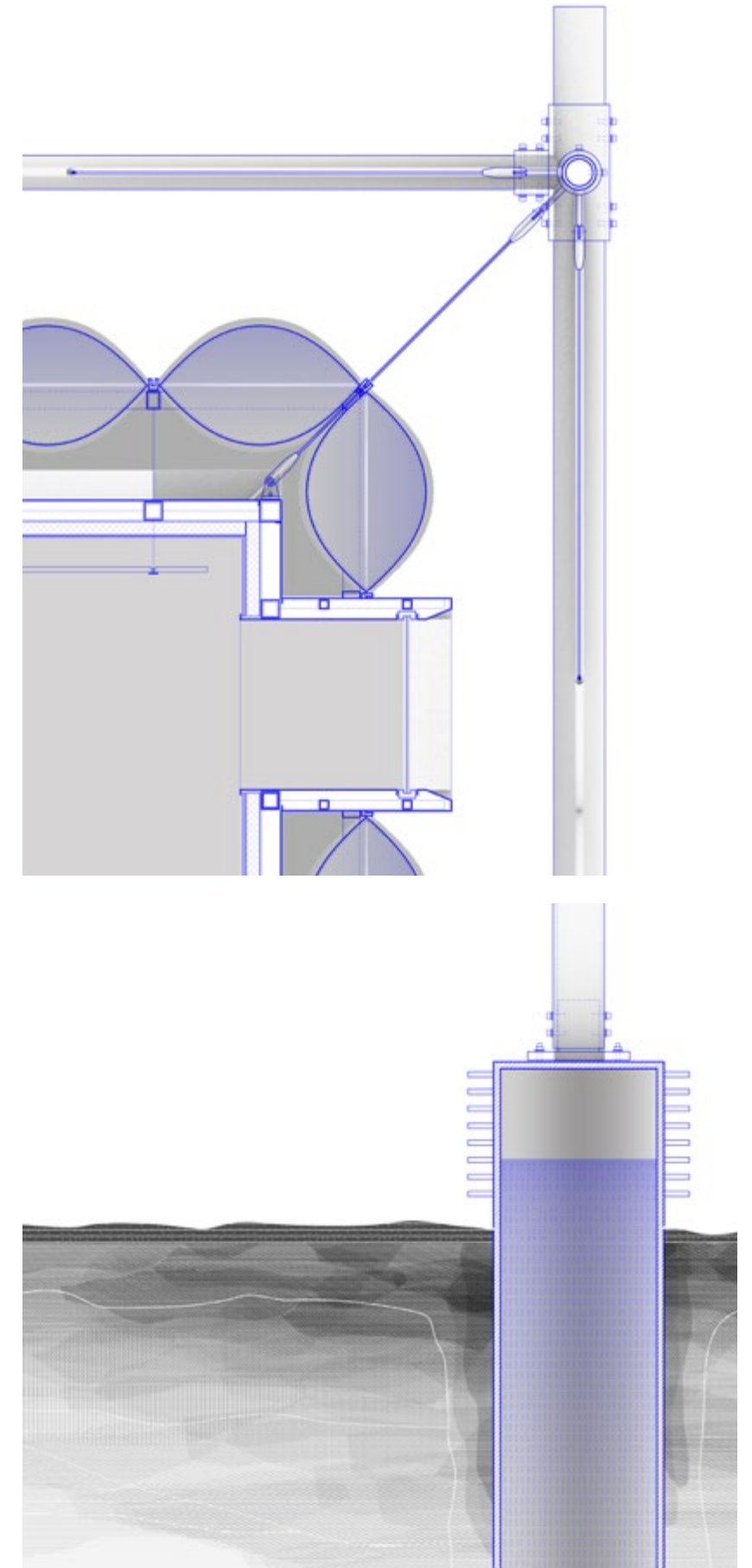
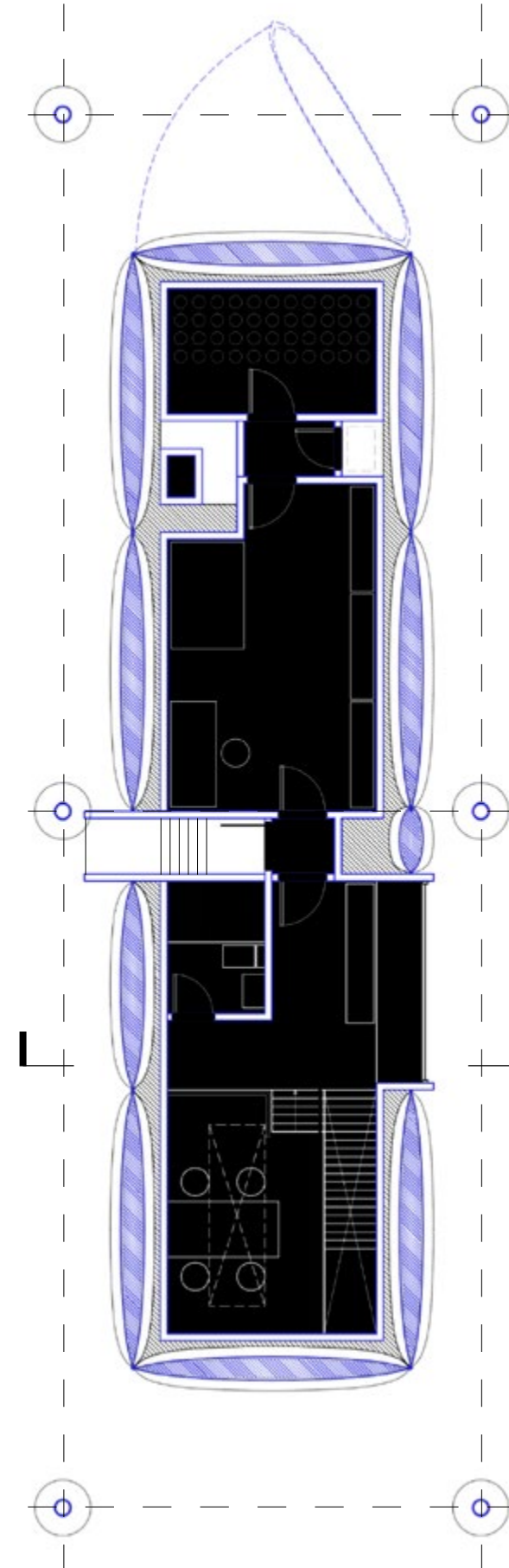
Measuring

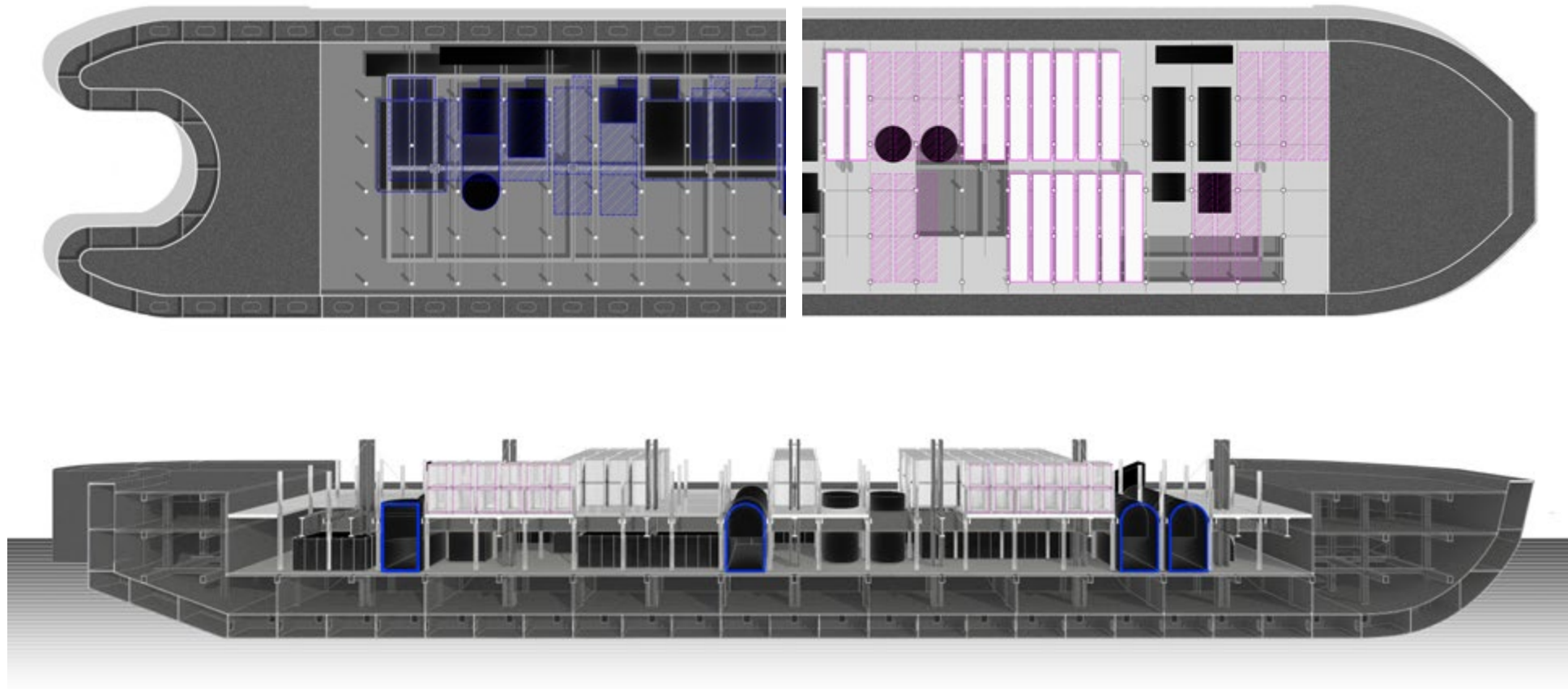
Measuring the Albedo Effect is fundamentally a matter of scale and resolution, using different grids to investigate and collect data. At the largest scale, satellite imagery monitors broad changes. On-site, a 10-meter measurement matrix is established to record continuous changes in the landscape topography. Individual measuring rods collect the actual melting snow and water.



Outpost

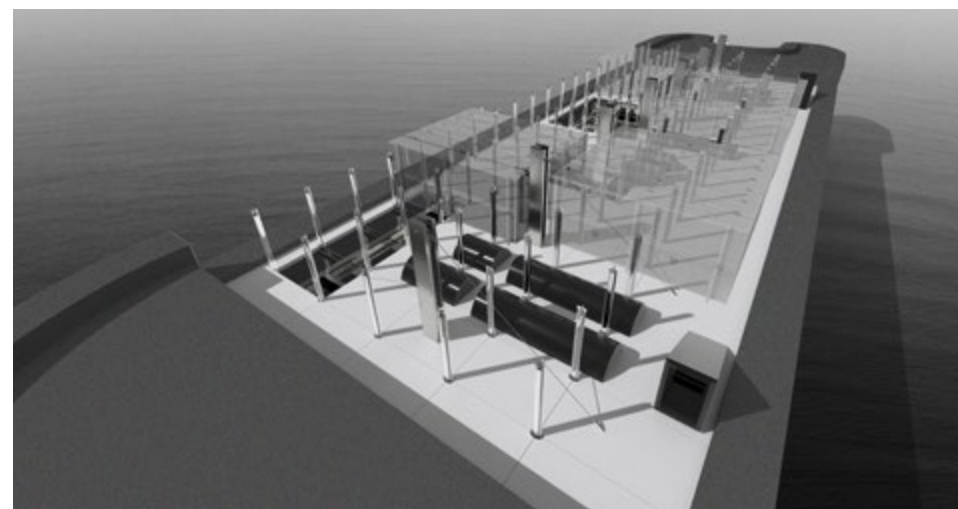
From a technical perspective, earth has a high specific heat capacity, enabling passive thermal regulation to control indoor temperatures. Once compacted and air-dried, rammed earth also offers structural stability and weather resistance. On a cultural level, earthworks provide tactile experiences through material texture, as well as temperature and humidity sensations.





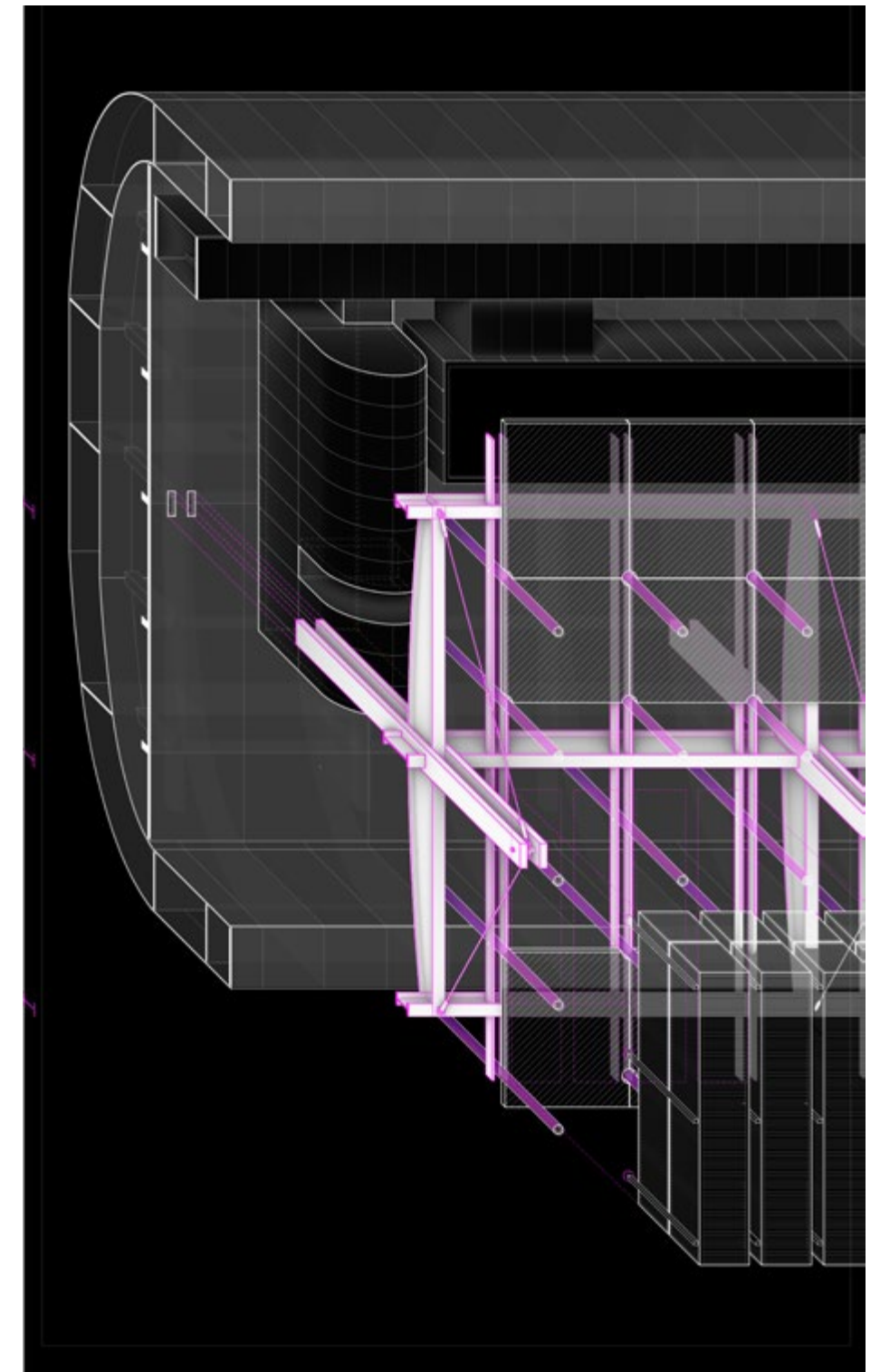
Forensic Return

When leaving the Arctic, it carries the archive as a "Forensic Return" to the rest of the world. Zooming into the ship itself, the architecture is divided by the deck : Below the deck, the space is dedicated to the scientific archive and exhibition.



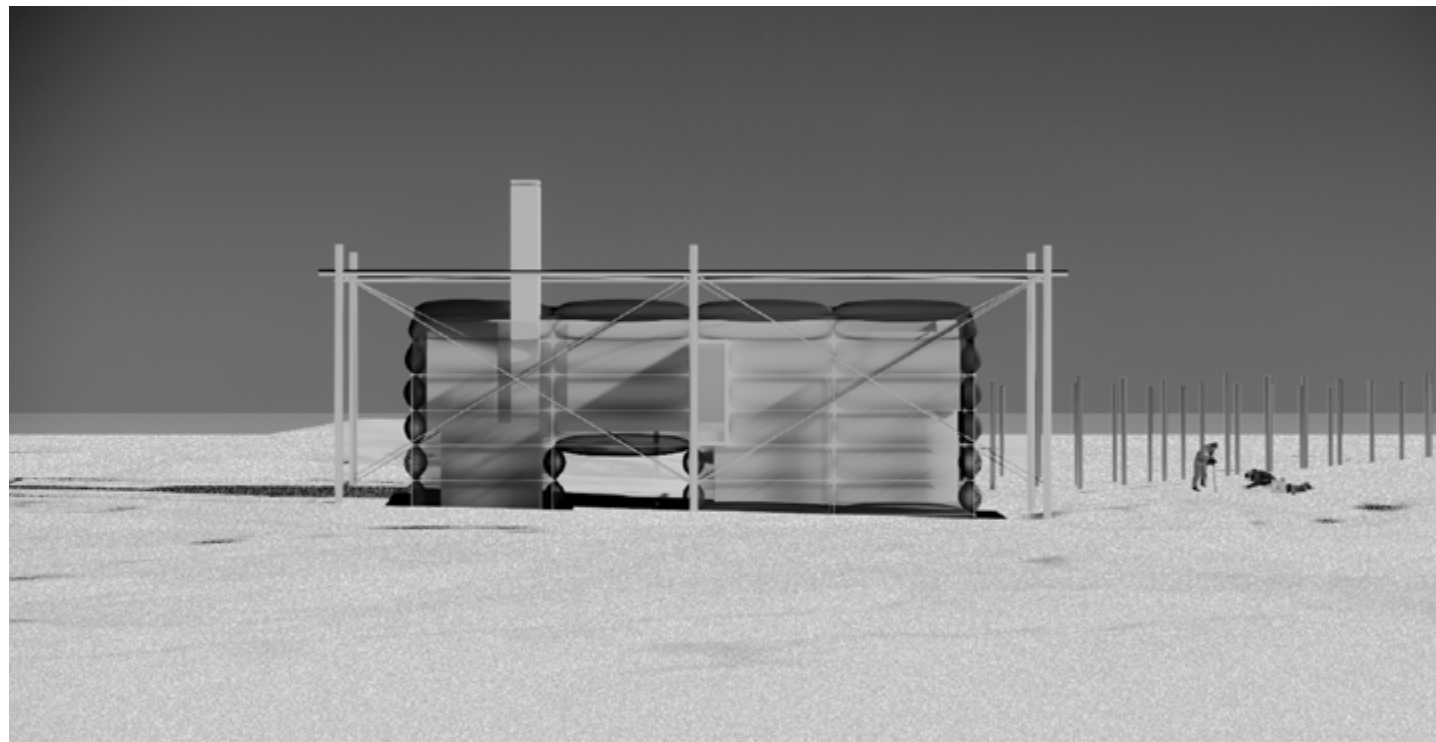
Investigative Supply

When returning to the Arctic, it acts as an "Investigative Supply," bringing resources back to the research stations. Above the deck, the ship carries standard shipping containers, participating in global supply traffic.



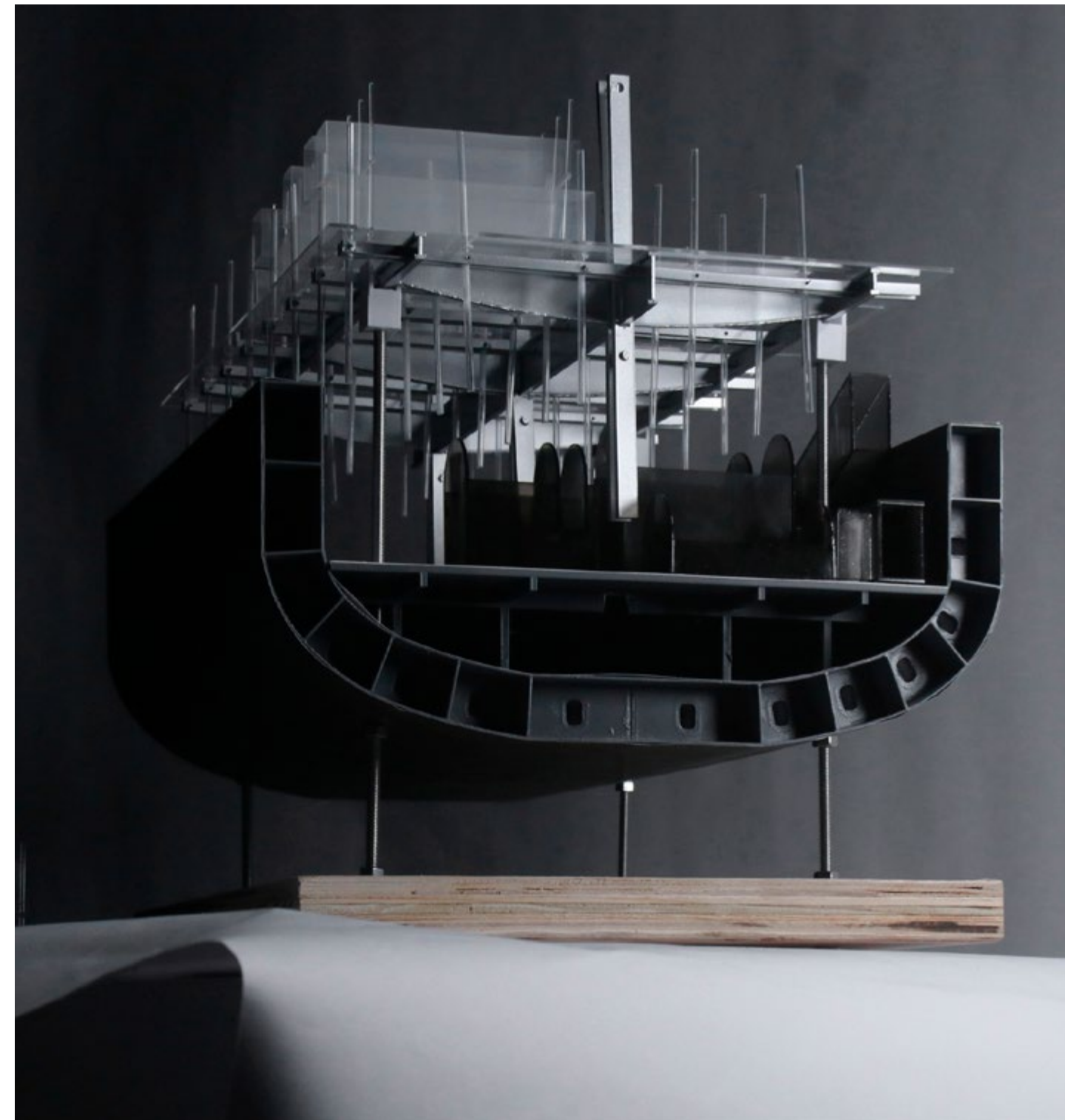
Science & Witness

The interior below deck is divided into the "Space of Science" and the "Space of Witness". The Space of Science holds the capsules, serving as functional cores where researchers live and conduct comparative experiments. The Space of Witness is the remaining void space that opens to the public when the ship docks, allowing them to witness the evidence of the Albedo Effect returned from the Arctic.



On-site to Non-site

The grid is viewed as a form of "on-site" extraction in the Arctic. This extracted data is then transferred to a "non-site" location for analysis and display. The overall design investigates how this collected dust is physically transported out of the Arctic context to disclose the hidden natural and political genealogy of these particles.



Agent&Route

The concept of the Archive is to move these Arctic samples back to the human world. The agent for this transfer is a barge ship, which acts as the mobile carrier for the data. A one-year cyclical route is designed for this vessel. This route passes through the direct sources of pollution, such as resource extraction and mining sites. It also connects to indirect sources, specifically the places of consumption in Europe and Asia.